

COMPREHENSION

Direction :- [Q .1. to Q .297.] Read the following passages and answer the questions that follow.

Examination wise Questions

SSC CGL 2025 Tier - I

SET - 1 [Q .1. to Q .5.]

The burgeoning field of epigenetics has revolutionized our understanding of heredity, extending beyond the simplistic Mendelian model of gene transmission. Traditionally, genetics focused on the DNA sequence itself as the sole determinant of an organism's traits. However, epigenetics reveals that environmental factors, lifestyle choices, and even historical traumas can profoundly influence gene expression without altering the underlying DNA code. These epigenetic modifications – such as DNA methylation and histone acetylation – act as molecular switches, turning genes on or off, or modulating their activity levels. This plasticity means that an identical twin, despite sharing an identical genome with their sibling, can develop different susceptibilities to disease or even exhibit distinct personality traits due to divergent epigenetic landscapes shaped by their individual experiences. Furthermore, some epigenetic tags can be inherited across generations, implying that the choices and environments of our ancestors might subtly predispose us to certain conditions or capabilities. This intergenerational inheritance challenges long-held notions of fixed genetic destiny, suggesting a dynamic interplay between nature and nurture where nurture can directly influence which parts of our nature are expressed. The implications are far-reaching, from developing novel therapeutic strategies for diseases like cancer to reframing public health interventions that consider transgenerational environmental impacts. Understanding epigenetics compels us to view biological inheritance not as a rigid blueprint, but as a malleable score being continuously re-orchestrated by life itself.

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.1. What is the main focus of epigenetics according to the passage?

- (a) Altering DNA sequences directly.
- (b) The study of gene expression without changing DNA.
- (c) Mendelian patterns of inheritance.
- (d) Developing new genetic diseases.

Q.2. What do DNA methylation and histone acetylation do in epigenetics?

- (a) They change the DNA sequence.
- (b) They turn genes on or off.
- (c) They create new diseases.
- (d) They make genetic traits unchangeable.

Q.3. How does epigenetics affect our idea of fixed genetic destiny?

- (a) It shows DNA sequences always change.
- (b) It shows the environment can change inherited traits.
- (c) It proves all twins are exactly alike.
- (d) It only focuses on physical looks.

Q.4. What does "malleable score" mean for our genetic

inheritance?

- (a) A set plan that cannot be changed.
- (b) A fixed musical score.
- (c) A flexible genetic plan that life experiences can change.
- (d) Strict rules from our ancestors.

Q.5. Which of these is NOT something we learn from epigenetics, according to the passage?

- (a) New ways to treat diseases.
- (b) New ideas for public health.
- (c) That genes are always stronger than environment.
- (d) How environment affects future generations.

SET - 2 [Q .6. to Q .10.]

The digital divide, a chasm separating those with access to modern information and communication technology (ICT) from those without, poses a significant challenge to equitable development. While the internet offers unparalleled opportunities for education, economic growth, and civic participation, billions globally remain unconnected or lack the necessary digital literacy to leverage its benefits. This divide is not merely about access to hardware like smartphones or computers; it encompasses disparities in broadband connectivity, affordability, quality of service, and the skills needed to effectively navigate the digital landscape. In developed nations, the divide often manifests as a gap between urban and rural areas, or between different socio-economic groups. In developing countries, it is a more fundamental barrier, with entire regions lacking basic infrastructure. The consequences are profound: those on the wrong side of the divide face reduced educational opportunities, limited access to remote work, exclusion from e-governance services, and a diminished voice in the global conversation. Bridging this gap requires multi-faceted interventions, including government initiatives to expand infrastructure, subsidies to make internet access affordable, and comprehensive digital literacy programmes. Furthermore, content must be culturally relevant and multilingual to ensure inclusivity. Ultimately, ensuring universal access and digital competence is not just about technology; it's about fostering social equality and ensuring that no one is left behind in the rapidly advancing digital age.

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.6. What is the main idea of the passage?

- (a) The rise of new technologies.
- (b) The challenges and consequences of the digital divide.
- (c) The benefits of fast internet.
- (d) How governments provide technology.

Q.7. What does the "digital divide" primarily refer to?

- (a) A gap between old and new technology.
- (b) The difference in access to modern technology and related skills.
- (c) The separation of digital and analogue devices.
- (d) A boundary between online and offline activities.

Q.8. Besides hardware, what other factors contribute to the digital divide?

- (a) Only the cost of software.
- (b) Broadband quality and digital skills.
- (c) The number of available apps.
- (d) The speed of social media.

Q.9. What is one major consequence for those on the "wrong side" of the digital divide?

- (a) Increased opportunities for remote work.
- (b) Better access to e-governance services.
- (c) Reduced educational opportunities.
- (d) A louder voice in global conversations.

Q.10. What is one suggested solution to bridge the digital divide?

- (a) Reducing the number of available online platforms.
- (b) Governments expanding infrastructure.
- (c) Focusing only on urban areas.
- (d) Limiting access to content.

SET - 3 [Q .11. to Q .15.]

The symbiotic relationship between flowering plants and their pollinators is a cornerstone of global biodiversity and ecosystem stability. Pollinators, primarily insects like bees, butterflies, and moths, but also birds and bats, play a crucial role in the reproduction of over 80% of the world's flowering plants, including many food crops essential for human sustenance. As these animals visit flowers to feed on nectar or pollen, they inadvertently transfer pollen grains from one flower to another, enabling fertilization. This intricate dance has evolved over millions of years, leading to highly specialized adaptations in both plants and pollinators. For instance, some flowers have evolved specific shapes, colors, or scents to attract particular pollinators, while pollinators have developed specialized mouthparts or behaviors to access the rewards offered by these flowers.

However, this vital relationship is under severe threat from various anthropogenic factors. Habitat loss due to urbanization and agriculture, pesticide use (especially neonicotinoids), climate change altering bloom times, and the spread of diseases and invasive species are collectively contributing to a dramatic decline in pollinator populations worldwide. The consequences of this decline are far-reaching. Beyond the ecological impact on wild plant reproduction, there are significant economic implications for agriculture. Many fruits, vegetables, and nuts rely heavily on animal pollination, and a reduction in pollinator services can lead to lower yields, reduced quality, and increased food costs. Scientists are actively researching solutions, from promoting pollinator-friendly farming practices and creating urban pollinator gardens to developing less harmful pest management strategies and conserving natural habitats. Understanding and protecting these unsung heroes of our ecosystems is paramount for food security and the health of our planet.

SSC CGL 12/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.11. What is the central role of pollinators in ecosystems, as described in the passage?

- (a) To decompose organic matter.
- (b) To facilitate plant reproduction.
- (c) To regulate water cycles.
- (d) To control pest populations.

Q.12. According to the passage, what type of adaptations have plants developed to attract pollinators?

- (a) Root structures
- (b) Specific shapes, colors, or scents
- (c) Photosynthetic efficiency
- (d) Drought resistance

Q.13. Which of the following is NOT listed as a threat to pollinator populations ?

- (a) Habitat loss
- (b) Pesticide use
- (c) Increased rainfall
- (d) Climate change

Q.14. What are the economic implications of declining pollinator

populations mentioned in the passage ?

- (a) Increased timber production
- (b) Lower crop yields and higher food costs
- (c) Decreased demand for agricultural labor
- (d) Greater reliance on fossil fuels

Q.15. What is suggested as a solution to protect pollinators ?

- (a) Encouraging deforestation
- (b) Developing more harmful pest management strategies
- (c) Promoting pollinator-friendly farming practices
- (d) Reducing global trade

SET - 4 [Q .16. to Q .20.]

The air in the kitchen was thick with unspoken words, heavier than the simmering stew on the hob. Fifteen-year-old Liam stared at his phone, thumb scrolling endlessly, while his mother, Sarah, meticulously arranged vegetables on a chopping board, each slice a deliberate effort to avoid eye contact. It had been like this for weeks, ever since the text message, the one that splintered their comfortable silence. "Why can't you just talk to me?" Sarah's voice was low, strained, finally breaking the quiet. Liam flinched, his jaw tightening. "There's nothing to talk about." A familiar, brick-wall response. He knew what she wanted – an explanation for his sudden withdrawal, the late nights, the abrupt change in his friend group. But how could he explain the pressure, the constant barrage of judgment from online 'friends' he barely knew, the relentless need to project an image of effortless cool ?

He remembered the first time he'd felt the sting of exclusion – a meme, shared widely in his class group chat, subtly mocking his older brother's passion for chess. He'd laughed along, a hollow, uncomfortable sound, desperate to fit in. Then came the 'dares,' escalating from minor pranks to something that made his stomach clench with fear. He'd tried to pull away, to mute the notifications, but the fear of being truly alone, ostracized from the only social circle he currently had, was suffocating. His old friends, the ones he'd shared genuine laughter with, felt distant, almost alien now. Sarah sighed, a sound of profound weariness. "Liam, I see you. I see you pulling away, shutting down. Whatever it is, we can face it together." He heard the tremor in her voice, the genuine concern, but a powerful knot of shame and fear kept his lips sealed. He glanced up, his eyes meeting hers for a fleeting second – a cavern of unspoken anxiety reflected in his gaze before he retreated back behind the glow of his screen, the silent battle raging on.

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.16. What is the main reason for the tension between Liam and his mother, Sarah ?

- (a) Liam's poor academic performance.
- (b) A recent argument about chores.
- (c) Liam's unexplained withdrawal and behavioral changes.
- (d) Sarah's disapproval of Liam's old friends.

Q.17. What caused Liam to initially participate in activities he was uncomfortable with ?

- (a) A genuine interest in pranks and dares.
- (b) Pressure from his mother.
- (c) The fear of exclusion and desire to fit in.
- (d) His older brother's influence.

Q.18. How does Liam's interaction with his old friends compare to his current social circle ?

- (a) His old friends are closer to him now.

- (b) His current social circle offers more genuine laughter.
- (c) His old friends feel distant, almost alien now.
- (d) He has completely cut off communication with his old friends.

Q.19. What emotional barrier prevents Liam from opening up to his mother ?

- (a) Anger and resentment.
- (b) A powerful knot of shame and fear.
- (c) A desire for independence.
- (d) Lack of trust in his mother.

Q.20. What is the author's primary purpose in writing this passage ?

- (a) To criticize parental overreach in adolescent lives.
- (b) To highlight the dangers of excessive screen time.
- (c) To explore the internal and external pressures teenagers face in social dynamics.
- (d) To advocate for stricter rules regarding online communication.

SET - 5 [Q .21. to Q .25.]

The perennial discussion surrounding the value of a liberal arts education in a technologically driven world often pits practical, vocational training against broader intellectual development. Critics argue that in an era demanding specialized skills and immediate job readiness, degrees in fields like philosophy, literature, or history are impractical and fail to equip graduates for the modern workforce. They emphasize the need for STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) fields, which directly contribute to economic growth and offer clearer career paths with higher earning potential, asserting that a focus on specific, marketable skills is the most efficient route to professional success.

However, proponents of a liberal arts education contend that its value lies precisely in its capacity to cultivate adaptable, critical thinkers—qualities that are increasingly vital in a rapidly changing global landscape. Instead of narrowly focusing on 'what to think,' a liberal arts curriculum teaches 'how to think.' It exposes students to a wide range of disciplines, fostering intellectual curiosity, analytical reasoning, effective communication, and problem-solving abilities that transcend specific industries or technologies. Graduates learn to interpret complex information, articulate persuasive arguments, understand diverse cultural contexts, and approach challenges from multiple perspectives—skills that are foundational for leadership, innovation, and civic engagement.

In a world where automation and AI are poised to transform many specialized jobs, the uniquely human capacities developed through a liberal arts education—creativity, ethical reasoning, empathy, and holistic understanding—become more, not less, valuable. Employers increasingly seek individuals who can adapt to new challenges, collaborate effectively, and contribute to organizational culture, rather than merely possessing a narrow technical skill set that might quickly become obsolete. Therefore, a liberal arts education, far from being impractical, provides a robust intellectual toolkit that prepares individuals not just for a first job, but for a lifetime of learning, career transitions, and meaningful contributions to society.

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.21. What is the primary argument made by critics against a liberal arts education?

- (a) It is too expensive compared to STEM degrees.
- (b) It fails to provide immediate job readiness and specialized

skills for the modern workforce.

- (c) It does not encourage intellectual curiosity.
- (d) It focuses too much on science and technology.

Q.22. According to proponents, what is a key benefit of a liberal arts curriculum regarding critical thinking?

- (a) It teaches students 'what to think'.
- (b) It narrowly focuses on specific industry skills.
- (c) It teaches students 'how to think'.
- (d) It primarily emphasizes rote memorization.

Q.23. Which of the following is NOT listed as a skill fostered by a liberal arts education ?

- (a) Analytical reasoning
- (b) Effective communication
- (c) Problem-solving abilities
- (d) Specialized vocational training

Q.24. In the context of automation and AI, what does the passage suggest about the value of uniquely human capacities developed through liberal arts ?

- (a) They become less relevant.
- (b) They become more valuable.
- (c) They are replaced by technical skills.
- (d) They are only useful in non-profit sectors.

Q.25. What do employers increasingly seek, according to the passage, in a rapidly changing world ?

- (a) Individuals with only a narrow technical skill set.
- (b) Individuals who exclusively specialize in one technological field.
- (c) Individuals who can adapt to new challenges and collaborate effectively.
- (d) Individuals who avoid career transitions.

SET - 6 [Q .26. to Q .30.]

With the rapid advancement of digital technology, reading habits have undergone a dramatic transformation. A few decades ago, printed books and newspapers were the primary sources of information and leisure reading. Today, digital screens dominate our lives, offering instant access to e-books, online articles, and news portals. While this shift has made reading more convenient, it has also raised concerns about declining attention spans and reduced comprehension. Researchers suggest that reading on screens often leads to superficial engagement, as readers tend to skim rather than absorb information deeply. Printed books, on the other hand, encourage focus and retention through a more immersive experience.

Despite these concerns, digital reading has several undeniable advantages. It allows users to carry thousands of books in one device, provides built-in dictionaries for quick reference, and ensures accessibility for people with visual impairments through adjustable fonts and audio support. Moreover, digital platforms promote environmental sustainability by reducing paper consumption. However, some educators argue that an overreliance on screens can cause eye strain, fatigue, and even disrupt sleep patterns due to prolonged exposure to blue light. Ultimately, the debate between digital and print reading is not about choosing one over the other, but about achieving balance. Readers can enjoy the convenience of technology while still preserving the depth of traditional reading. By practising mindful reading—whether on paper or screen—individuals can ensure that technology enhances rather than weakens their intellectual engagement.

SSC CGL 13/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.26. What is the main concern raised about digital reading ?

- (a) It is more expensive than printed books



- (b) It reduces deep engagement and comprehension
- (c) It is unavailable in rural areas
- (d) It discourages vocabulary development

Q.27. What advantage does digital reading offer according to the passage ?

- (a) It increases paper usage
- (b) It limits accessibility
- (c) It provides portability and convenience
- (d) It reduces technological dependency

Q.28. What does the word “immersive” imply in the following sentence from the passage ?

“Printed books, on the other hand, encourage focus and retention through a more immersive experience.”

- (a) Distracting
- (b) Deeply engaging
- (c) Superficial
- (d) Boring

Q.29. How does digital reading support environmental sustainability ?

- (a) By reducing electricity use
- (b) By promoting online advertisements
- (c) By reducing paper consumption
- (d) By recycling electronic waste

Q.30. What balance does the author suggest in the passage ?

- (a) Completely avoiding digital reading
- (b) Preferring printed books over everything
- (c) Using both digital and print reading mindfully
- (d) Replacing all books with e-readers

SET - 7 [Q .31. to Q .35.]

India's journey in space exploration began in 1962 with the establishment of the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR) under the leadership of Dr. Vikram Sarabhai. What started with modest rocket launches from Thumba soon evolved into one of the world's most respected space programs. The formation of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) in 1969 marked a turning point, reflecting India's ambition to harness space technology for national development. Over the decades, ISRO achieved remarkable milestones – from launching the Aryabhata satellite in 1975 to the Chandrayaan and Mangalyaan missions that showcased India's prowess in lunar and interplanetary exploration. However, the true transformation occurred in the 21st century. With the successful launch of the Chandrayaan-3 mission in 2023, India became the first nation to land on the Moon's south pole, a feat celebrated globally. The mission highlighted ISRO's cost-effective innovation and technical expertise. Meanwhile, projects like Gaganyaan, India's first human spaceflight program, signify the country's leap toward manned missions. ISRO's collaborations with private space startups and global agencies are also expanding the frontiers of innovation, aiming to make India a key player in the global space economy. Yet, challenges persist – limited budgets, brain drain, and the need for continuous technological upgrades. Still, India's space vision remains clear: to combine affordability, innovation, and global collaboration to reach new cosmic milestones.

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.31. When was the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) established ?

- (a) 1962
- (b) 1969
- (c) 1975
- (d) 1984

Q.32. Which mission made India the first country to land on the Moon's south pole?

- (a) Chandrayaan-2
- (b) Mangalyaan
- (c) Chandrayaan-3
- (d) Gaganyaan

Q.33. What does the Gaganyaan project aim to achieve ?

- (a) Launch India's first Mars rover
- (b) Conduct India's first human spaceflight
- (c) Build a permanent space station
- (d) Launch low-cost communication satellites

Q.34. Which factor is NOT mentioned as a challenge for India's space program ?

- (a) Limited funding
- (b) Brain drain
- (c) Lack of public interest
- (d) Need for technological upgrades

Q.35. What best describes India's long -term vision in space exploration ?

- (a) To compete with Western nations at any cost
- (b) To combine affordability, innovation, and collaboration
- (c) To focus only on manned missions
- (d) To depend entirely on foreign space agencies

SET - 8 [Q .36. to Q .40.]

In the contemporary era, the relationship between technology and human cognition has become increasingly intertwined. Digital tools have transformed how we process, store, and retrieve information. On one hand, technology enhances efficiency – allowing instantaneous access to knowledge, fostering global communication, and enabling complex problem-solving. On the other hand, constant digital engagement has raised concerns about attention fragmentation, superficial learning, and declining memory retention. Psychologists argue that reliance on external devices for information storage—commonly termed as “digital amnesia”—may erode our natural cognitive abilities. When individuals delegate tasks like remembering phone numbers, dates, or even directions to devices, they strengthen convenience but weaken mental endurance. However, advocates of digital integration claim that such delegation allows the human mind to focus on higher-order thinking rather than routine recall. They argue that every technological revolution—printing press, calculator, or computer—has similarly redefined intelligence rather than diminished it. The central challenge, therefore, is not resisting technology but using it judiciously—balancing cognitive independence with technological assistance. The future of human intellect will likely depend on how effectively individuals cultivate mindfulness in an age of mental automation.

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.36. Which of the following best captures the essence of the passage ?

- (a) Technology has made human cognition obsolete.
- (b) Technology has both enhanced and challenged human cognition.
- (c) Digital tools have replaced human intelligence.
- (d) People should completely avoid dependence on technology.

Q.37. Which of the following is a concern raised by psychologists in the passage?

- (a) Technology limits creativity and curiosity.
- (b) Technology causes people to forget essential information.
- (c) Technology has made learning too slow.
- (d) Technology eliminates the need for education.

Q.38. How do advocates of digital integration defend technology

use?

- (a) They believe technology replaces memory entirely.
- (b) They argue it allows the mind to focus on complex thinking.
- (c) They insist humans should rely solely on devices.
- (d) They reject traditional intelligence models.

Q.39. What tone does the author adopt toward technological influence on human intellect ?

- (a) Pessimistic and alarmist (b) Balanced and reflective
- (c) Sarcastic and dismissive (d) Nostalgic and regretful

Q.40. What is the central concern raised in the passage ?

- (a) Whether technology should replace human intelligence
- (b) How to balance cognitive independence with technological reliance
- (c) Why humans are addicted to devices
- (d) When artificial intelligence will surpass human memory

SET - 9 [Q .41. to Q .45.]

The use of renewable energy has become a global priority as countries strive to reduce their dependence on fossil fuels. Renewable sources such as solar, wind, and hydroelectric power offer cleaner alternatives that help lower carbon emissions and combat climate change. However, the transition to renewable energy is not without challenges. The initial cost of setting up infrastructure remains high, and energy production can be inconsistent due to weather conditions. Despite these drawbacks, technological innovations are making renewable energy more efficient and affordable.

Governments are also encouraging the shift through subsidies, tax incentives, and investment in research. These measures not only help reduce environmental damage but also create employment opportunities in new sectors. Public awareness about sustainability has further accelerated the demand for cleaner energy options. The future of global energy lies in a balanced approach—using renewable sources while continuing to improve storage technologies and grid efficiency. If nations maintain this momentum, renewable energy could soon replace conventional sources as the dominant form of power.

SSC CGL 14/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.41. What is the primary reason countries are adopting renewable energy sources?

- (a) To increase energy prices
- (b) To reduce carbon emissions
- (c) To promote fossil fuel industries
- (d) To decrease international cooperation

Q.42. What is one major challenge in the transition to renewable energy ?

- (a) Lack of government interest
- (b) High maintenance costs of fossil fuels
- (c) High initial setup costs and inconsistent production
- (d) Limited natural resources

Q.43. What role do governments play in promoting renewable energy ?

- (a) They discourage innovation in renewable technology
- (b) They provide financial and policy support to encourage its use
- (c) They restrict subsidies and incentives
- (d) They depend solely on private companies

Q.44. What does the passage suggest about the future of global energy?

- (a) It will rely only on fossil fuels
- (b) It will depend entirely on hydroelectric power
- (c) It will balance renewable and traditional sources
- (d) It will eliminate all forms of technology

Q.45. What does the word “momentum” imply in the sentence “If nations maintain this momentum, renewable energy could soon replace conventional sources as the dominant form of power” ?

- (a) Speed of technological change
- (b) Ongoing progress and drive
- (c) Sudden decline in interest
- (d) Lack of stability

SET - 10 [Q .46. to Q .50.]

In the contemporary world, silence has become an anomaly—an absence that many mistake for emptiness rather than presence. Yet, silence is not the negation of sound but its most profound counterpoint. It is within silence that reflection finds its voice, that thoughts distill into clarity, and that creativity germinates. In an age dominated by incessant notifications, ceaseless commentary, and performative expression, the ability to be silent is increasingly radical. Philosophers from Lao Tzu to Wittgenstein have observed that language, though powerful, often fractures experience into fragments that silence alone can reconcile. True understanding, therefore, may not always lie in articulation but in the spaces between words—the pauses that lend speech its meaning. Moreover, silence carries moral and emotional weight. It can soothe or wound, liberate or oppress. The silence of complicity sustains injustice, while the silence of contemplation heals. In relationships, silence can communicate intimacy or alienation, depending on intent and context. Thus, to master silence is not to abstain from speech but to discern when words enhance truth and when they obscure it. In learning to listen—to others, to nature, to ourselves—we recover a dimension of awareness long buried beneath the noise of modern life. Silence, then, is not absence but essence: the quiet pulse beneath the surface of existence that restores depth to being.

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.46. According to the passage, the author views silence primarily as —

- (a) A passive withdrawal from the world
- (b) An essential component of understanding and awareness
- (c) A sign of weakness or submission
- (d) A threat to modern communication

Q.47. The author implies that excessive speech or noise in modern life:

- (a) Leads to deeper empathy
- (b) Enhances creative thinking
- (c) Fragmentizes experience and diminishes reflection
- (d) Strengthens social harmony

Q.48. Which of the following best captures the paradox of silence as discussed in the passage?

- (a) Silence both conceals and reveals truth.
- (b) Silence is the absence of emotion.
- (c) Silence is meaningless without speech.
- (d) Silence is superior to all forms of expression.

Q.49. What tone does the author primarily adopt in the passage?

- (a) Reflective and philosophical (b) Cynical and dismissive
- (c) Playful and humorous (d) Coldly analytical

Q.50. In the context of the passage, the word anomaly most

nearly means:

- (a) A deviation from the norm (b) A hidden truth
(c) A universal pattern (d) A minor interruption

SET - 11 [Q .51. to Q .55.]

Science, as both a method and an institution, occupies a paradoxical position within modern society. It promises objectivity, progress, and mastery over nature, yet it simultaneously engenders profound ethical dilemmas. The relentless pursuit of innovation often outpaces moral reflection, leaving humanity to confront consequences it is ill-prepared to manage. From genetic modification to artificial intelligence, scientific advancement expands the boundaries of what can be done, while offering little guidance on what should be done. This widening gap between capability and conscience underscores the need for an ethical framework that evolves in tandem with discovery. Historically, science has been regarded as a neutral enterprise—its value determined by human application. However, this notion of neutrality is increasingly untenable in a world where data, algorithms, and biotechnologies directly shape social realities. The scientist no longer functions solely as an observer but as an active agent of transformation, capable of altering both the environment and the human condition itself. Consequently, the question of responsibility becomes inseparable from the act of inquiry.

Ethics, then, cannot remain external to science; it must be integrated within its very methodology. The development of nuclear weapons, surveillance technologies, and environmental exploitation has demonstrated that knowledge divorced from moral accountability leads to existential peril. In this sense, ethical deliberation is not an impediment to progress but its precondition. The challenge lies in reconciling the empirical rigor of science with the normative demands of ethics—an endeavor that requires humility, dialogue, and an awareness of science's sociopolitical embeddedness. To imagine science as detached from values is to ignore the historical record of how power and ideology have influenced research agendas, from colonial anthropology to corporate-funded pharmacology. In the twenty-first century, as humanity stands at the threshold of genetic redesign and machine consciousness, the integration of ethical reasoning into scientific practice is no longer optional but essential. The true measure of scientific progress will thus depend not merely on discovery, but on discernment—on our collective ability to wield knowledge without surrendering wisdom.

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.51. According to the passage, why is the traditional notion of scientific neutrality considered “untenable” ?

- (a) Science has lost its empirical foundation.
(b) Modern research is influenced by social and political forces.
(c) Scientists no longer rely on observation.
(d) Technology has replaced the need for experimentation.

Q.52. What does the author imply about the relationship between ethics and progress?

- (a) Ethics restricts technological innovation.
(b) Ethical reflection is essential for genuine progress.
(c) Scientific progress occurs independently of ethics.
(d) Ethical principles are obsolete in modern science.

Q.53. Which of the following best captures the meaning of “capability and conscience” in the passage ?

- (a) Technical ability versus moral responsibility.
(b) Knowledge versus ignorance.

(c) Ambition versus fear.

(d) Discovery versus application.

Q.54. The author's tone toward science can best be described as:

- (a) Condemnatory and pessimistic. (b) Analytical and cautionary.
(c) Detached and indifferent. (d) Romantic and idealistic.

Q.55. The closest meaning of the word “discernment” as used in the passage is:

- (a) Confusion (b) Judgment (c) Repetition (d) Achievement

SET - 12 [Q .56. to Q .60.]

The private sector, particularly in the current global economic climate, is characterised by a significant degree of volatility. Businesses, from small enterprises to multinational corporations, constantly navigate a landscape riddled with unpredictable shifts. This inherent instability stems from a multitude of factors, both internal and external, creating an environment where adaptability is not merely an option but a critical necessity for survival and growth.

Externally, geopolitical events play a substantial role. Trade wars, international sanctions, and political instability in key regions can disrupt supply chains, alter market access, and inflate operational costs almost overnight. Furthermore, technological advancements, while offering immense opportunities, also present a double-edged sword. Rapid innovation can render existing products or services obsolete, forcing companies to invest heavily in research and development or risk falling behind competitors. Consumer preferences, driven by evolving social trends and increased environmental consciousness, are another potent force for change. A sudden shift in public sentiment towards sustainability, for example, can drastically impact demand for certain goods and compel industries to re-evaluate their production methods.

Internally, companies face their own set of challenges. Labour market fluctuations, including shortages of skilled workers or rising wage demands, can exert immense pressure on operational budgets. Financial market instability, such as interest rate hikes or credit crunches, directly affects investment capacity and expansion plans. Moreover, the increasing pace of regulatory changes, especially in areas like environmental compliance and data protection, requires continuous vigilance and often significant expenditure to ensure adherence.

This pervasive volatility mandates a strategic shift towards resilience. Businesses are increasingly investing in robust risk management frameworks, diversifying their supply bases, and fostering cultures of continuous learning and innovation. The ability to pivot quickly, reallocate resources efficiently, and anticipate future disruptions is paramount. Those that fail to build such organisational agility often find themselves unable to weather the storms of modern commerce, underscoring that in today's private sector, the only constant is change itself.

SSC CGL 15/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.56. What does the passage state is a critical necessity for businesses in the volatile private sector ?

- (a) Maintaining static business models.
(b) Adaptability.
(c) Avoiding all forms of risk.
(d) Focusing only on short-term profits.

Q.57. Which of the following is an external factor contributing to private sector volatility ?

- (a) Labour market fluctuations. (b) Financial market instability.

- (c) Rising wage demands. (d) Geopolitical events.

Q.58. According to the passage, how can technological advancements be seen as a "double-edged sword" ?

- (a) They reduce operational costs but eliminate jobs.
 (b) They offer opportunities but can make existing products obsolete.
 (c) They simplify supply chains but increase regulatory scrutiny.
 (d) They improve efficiency but always lead to financial instability.

Q.59. What is one of the internal challenges mentioned that companies face due to volatility ?

- (a) Shifting consumer preferences.
 (b) International sanctions.
 (c) Labour market fluctuations.
 (d) Disruptions in global supply chains.

Q.60. What strategic shift is mandated for businesses to manage pervasive volatility ?

- (a) Limiting investment in research and development.
 (b) Avoiding diversification of supply bases.
 (c) Building resilience through risk management and agility.
 (d) Resisting all forms of regulatory changes.

SET - 13 [Q .61. to Q .65.]

In the architecture of digital consciousness, where algorithms increasingly dictate perception, the boundary between autonomy and automation becomes perilously thin. Every scroll, click, or pause is parsed by unseen systems that learn, adapt, and anticipate—creating a feedback loop where human preference is both the input and the product. The illusion of choice, sustained by the abundance of content, often conceals a subtle curation of thought. Recommendation engines, cloaked in neutrality, are in fact value-laden mechanisms shaped by data hierarchies and corporate imperatives. What appears as personalization may instead be algorithmic determinism—a world where our desires are gently steered rather than freely formed. Moreover, the architecture of attention has been commodified; distraction is not a side effect but a business model. Cognitive overload diminishes reflection, while emotional triggers amplify engagement. In this ecosystem, outrage travels faster than nuance, and visibility becomes the currency of relevance. Even the language of digital ethics —transparency, accountability, inclusion —struggles to keep pace with the velocity of innovation. Artificial intelligence, though often portrayed as an impartial arbiter, inherits the biases of its creators and the data it consumes. It replicates not just human intelligence, but also human prejudice. Yet amid this algorithmic opacity lies a paradox of empowerment: never before has humanity possessed such access to knowledge and connectivity, yet never has it been more vulnerable to manipulation. The challenge is not to dismantle technology but to rehumanize it—to ensure that the circuitry of progress serves human discernment rather than diminishes it.

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.61. What is the central idea of the passage?

- (a) Artificial intelligence enhances human freedom.
 (b) Algorithms have made decision - making more objective.
 (c) Digital systems subtly influence human perception and autonomy.
 (d) The internet is an entirely neutral platform for expression.

Q.62. The phrase "illusion of choice" suggests that—

- (a) users have unlimited freedom online.
 (b) online options appear diverse but are algorithmically curated.
 (c) individuals consciously control digital algorithms.
 (d) personalization eliminates manipulation.

Q.63. What does the author imply about artificial intelligence ethics?

- (a) It fully resolves issues of bias.
 (b) It evolves faster than innovation.
 (c) It mirrors existing human flaws.
 (d) It prevents algorithmic manipulation.

Q.64. Which of the following best explains the paradox mentioned in the passage ?

- (a) Technology isolates and empowers simultaneously.
 (b) Algorithms are neutral and self-correcting.
 (c) Human desires cannot be predicted.
 (d) Data has lost all ethical significance.

Q.65. The author's tone in the passage can best be described as—

- (a) Alarmist yet hopeful (b) Indifferent and detached
 (c) Sarcastic and mocking (d) Celebratory and optimistic

SET - 14 [Q .66. to Q .70.]

India, a nation celebrated for its vibrant diversity and economic aspirations, concurrently navigates a labyrinth of persistent social challenges that often impede its journey towards genuinely inclusive development. While significant economic growth has lifted millions out of poverty, the benefits have not been uniformly distributed, leading to widening disparities. The pervasive issue of inequality is multi-dimensional, extending beyond mere income gaps to encompass unequal access to quality education, healthcare, and digital literacy. The historical stratification of society, particularly the enduring influence of the caste system, continues to perpetuate disadvantages for certain communities, despite constitutional provisions for affirmative action. Gender inequality remains another formidable barrier. Women, though increasingly visible in public life, frequently confront systemic discrimination, gender-based violence, and a significant wage gap. Their participation in the formal workforce, while growing, is still considerably lower than men's, reflecting deeply entrenched patriarchal norms that limit opportunities and autonomy.

Moreover, the strain on public health infrastructure is acute. India battles a dual burden of communicable and non - communicable diseases. Malnutrition and a lack of adequate sanitation, especially in rural and urban slum areas, contribute to high rates of infant mortality and morbidity. The recent pandemic starkly exposed the vulnerabilities of an overburdened healthcare system, underscoring the urgent need for greater investment and equitable distribution of medical resources. Simultaneously, environmental degradation poses an existential threat, particularly to vulnerable populations. Rapid industrialization and urban sprawl have led to alarming levels of air and water pollution, exacerbating respiratory illnesses and contaminating vital water sources. Deforestation contributes to ecological imbalances and climate change impacts, such as extreme weather events, which disproportionately affect agricultural communities and those reliant on natural resources. These issues are interconnected, forming a vicious cycle where poverty intensifies environmental vulnerability, and environmental harm further entrenches poverty and ill-health. Addressing these challenges necessitates a holistic approach: strengthening

governance, promoting ethical leadership, fostering robust public-private partnerships, and, crucially, empowering citizens through education and genuine participation. It demands a commitment to fostering a society where progress is measured not just by economic indicators, but by the well-being, equity, and dignity afforded to every single individual.

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.66. Beyond income gaps, what are other dimensions of inequality mentioned in the passage ?

- (a) Access to luxury goods and international travel.
- (b) Access to quality education, healthcare, and digital literacy.
- (c) Equal participation in entertainment industries.
- (d) Access to advanced scientific research.

Q.67. What specific challenges do women in India frequently face, despite legislative protections?

- (a) Overrepresentation in political spheres.
- (b) Systemic discrimination, violence, and a significant wage gap.
- (c) Exclusive access to advanced education.
- (d) A disproportionately high participation in the formal workforce.

Q.68. What dual burden does India's public health infrastructure battle?

- (a) Economic prosperity and social stability.
- (b) Communicable and non-communicable diseases.
- (c) Urban and rural health demands.
- (d) Advanced technology and traditional medicine.

Q.69. How does environmental degradation, such as pollution and deforestation, primarily impact society in India ?

- (a) It benefits urban areas by attracting investment.
- (b) It disproportionately affects the poorest segments and agricultural communities.
- (c) It has no significant impact due to economic growth.
- (d) It leads to an increase in natural resources.

Q.70. What is ultimately suggested as a measure of progress for Indian society?

- (a) Only strong economic indicators.
- (b) The well-being, equity, and dignity
- (c) The rate of industrialization and urbanization. afforded to every individual.
- (d) The number of new technological advancements.

SET - 15 [Q .71. to Q .75.]

In the evolving theatre of human creativity, the contest between originality and imitation has long animated debates about authenticity and value. Originality, often romanticized as the spark of divine inspiration, is revered as the lifeblood of artistic and intellectual progress. The original creator, unshackled by precedent, is celebrated as a pioneer who redefines the boundaries of the possible. Yet, imitation—frequently dismissed as parasitic mimicry — possesses its own quiet genius. To imitate with discernment is to study the anatomy of excellence; it is the apprenticeship through which mastery often gestates. The Renaissance, after all, flourished not through isolation but through reinterpretation. However, the fetishization of originality in modern culture risks estranging creators from the continuum of human knowledge. Every so-called innovation is, in essence, an echo refracted through time—an evolution rather than an eruption. Conversely, blind imitation breeds stagnation, where the act of creation devolves into mechanical repetition devoid of insight. The truth lies in equilibrium: originality must converse

with tradition even as it challenges it. The most profound works, whether in art, science, or thought, emerge not from rebellion alone but from synthesis — where imitation provides the scaffolding and originality raises the edifice. In this delicate dialectic, creativity becomes less an act of invention and more an act of intelligent remembrance, where the past is neither idolized nor ignored but transmuted into something enduringly new.

SSC CGL 16/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.71. Which of the following best describes the tone of the passage ?

- (a) Cynical (b) Analytical (c) Sentimental (d) Didactic

Q.72. The author suggests that imitation can serve as—

- (a) An obstacle to genuine creativity
- (b) A foundational process for achieving mastery
- (c) A meaningless repetition of prior work
- (d) A complete replacement for originality

Q.73. What does the author imply by “fetishization of originality”?

- (a) Society's excessive glorification of originality at the expense of learning from the past
- (b) The rejection of innovation in favor of traditional methods
- (c) The belief that imitation alone leads to mastery
- (d) The effort to balance creativity with discipline

Q.74. What is meant by the phrase “an echo refracted through time” ?

- (a) Every creative idea carries traces of the ideas that came before it.
- (b) Innovation always replaces the traditions of the past.
- (c) Modern art rejects all historical influences.
- (d) Time weakens the value of older creative works.

Q.75. From the author's perspective, true creativity arises when—

- (a) Originality is pursued in isolation from imitation
- (b) Tradition is preserved without modification
- (c) The old and the new are synthesized into meaningful innovation
- (d) The creator rejects all prior influence

SET - 16 [Q .76. to Q .80.]

The concept of artificial intelligence (AI) has moved from the realm of science fiction to a pervasive force reshaping industries and daily life. At its core, AI involves machines performing tasks that typically require human intelligence, such as learning, problem-solving, and decision-making. Early AI research, emerging in the mid-20th century, focused on symbolic reasoning and expert systems. However, the true inflection point arrived with advancements in machine learning, particularly deep learning, which leverages neural networks inspired by the human brain. This paradigm shift has led to breakthroughs in areas like image recognition, natural language processing, and autonomous systems. The integration of AI into various sectors — healthcare, finance, transportation, and education—promises unprecedented efficiencies and innovation. In medicine, AI assists in diagnostics, drug discovery, and personalized treatment plans, while in finance, it optimizes trading strategies and fraud detection. Yet, this rapid proliferation of AI is not without its challenges. Concerns about job displacement, algorithmic bias, privacy invasion, and the potential for autonomous weapons systems loom large. Ethical frameworks are struggling to keep pace with technological advancements,

leading to calls for robust regulation and responsible AI development. The 'black box' problem, where the decision-making processes of complex AI models are opaque, further complicates accountability. Moreover, the concentration of AI power in a few tech giants raises questions about market dominance and democratic control. Ultimately, the future of AI hinges on a delicate balance: harnessing its transformative potential while meticulously addressing its societal and ethical implications. A collaborative, interdisciplinary approach involving policymakers, technologists, ethicists, and the public will be crucial in steering AI towards a benevolent future.

SSC CGL 17/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.76. What was the primary focus of early AI research ?

- (a) Deep learning and neural networks
- (b) Symbolic reasoning and expert systems
- (c) Image recognition and autonomous systems
- (d) Natural language processing

Q.77. Which technological advancement is credited with enabling major breakthroughs in modern AI ?

- (a) Quantum computing
- (b) Advanced robotics
- (c) Machine learning, especially deep learning
- (d) Improved internet speeds

Q.78. According to the passage, what is meant by the 'black box' problem in AI ?

- (a) The physical design of AI hardware
- (b) The difficulty in understanding how complex AI models make decisions
- (c) The proprietary nature of AI software
- (d) The use of AI in classified government operations

Q.79. What ethical concern is not explicitly mentioned in the passage regarding AI's rapid proliferation ?

- (a) Job displacement
- (b) Algorithmic bias
- (c) Environmental impact
- (d) Privacy invasion

Q.80. What is presented as crucial for ensuring a benevolent future for AI ?

- (a) Limiting AI development to government agencies
- (b) Allowing market forces to self-regulate AI
- (c) A collaborative, interdisciplinary approach to development and policy
- (d) Focusing solely on military applications of AI

SET - 17 [Q .81. to Q .85.]

For decades, India's urban development has been synonymous with high-rise housing, metro lines, and glittering commercial spaces. However, beneath this glossy façade lies a less-discussed reality — the challenge of sustainable urbanisation. Rapid migration to cities has resulted in unplanned growth, overstretched infrastructure, and environmental degradation. The idea of a "smart city" is often celebrated as a futuristic solution, but without addressing basic issues such as waste management, water scarcity, and equitable housing, smartness remains superficial. Many urban local bodies still struggle with outdated administrative systems, limited financial autonomy, and dependence on central schemes. As a result, projects often prioritise visibility over viability.

Furthermore, the unequal distribution of resources across cities widens the urban divide. While metros like Delhi, Bengaluru, and Mumbai attract investment and innovation, smaller towns remain deprived of quality healthcare, education, and transport

networks. The migration of talent and labour from these towns perpetuates regional imbalance, creating overcrowded metropolises and depopulated hinterlands. Adding to the crisis is climate change, which magnifies vulnerabilities — floods in Chennai, heatwaves in Delhi, and air pollution in almost every major city highlight the unsustainable nature of urban growth.

The true test of urban progress lies not in skyscrapers or digital dashboards, but in liveability. Cities must be designed around people, not vehicles; around inclusivity, not exclusivity. Affordable housing, efficient public transport, and green spaces are not luxuries but essentials. Until policymaking shifts from optics to outcomes, India's urban transformation will remain incomplete — a tale of ambition that outpaces its foundation.

SSC CGL 17/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.81. What is the central issue discussed in the passage ?

- (a) Economic reforms in Indian cities
- (b) Unsustainable and unequal urban growth
- (c) Expansion of the smart city mission
- (d) Lack of employment in rural areas

Q.82. According to the passage, what makes the idea of "smart cities" superficial ?

- (a) Overuse of digital technologies
- (b) Poor investment in infrastructure
- (c) Ignoring core issues like waste and housing
- (d) Rapid migration of rural population

Q.83. What consequence arises from unequal resource distribution across cities ?

- (a) Overcrowded big cities and declining small towns
- (b) Reduced pollution and cleaner environment
- (c) Balanced regional economic growth
- (d) Lower cost of living in metropolitan areas

Q.84. What, according to the author, should be the focus of urban design ?

- (a) Speed and technology
- (b) Wealth generation
- (c) Human-centred inclusivity
- (d) Industrial expansion

Q.85. According to the passage, what must replace the current approach to achieve meaningful urban transformation?

- (a) Prioritising technology over human welfare
- (b) Reducing public spending on infrastructure
- (c) Expanding metropolitan boundaries rapidly
- (d) Shifting focus from appearance to genuine outcomes

SET - 18 [Q .86. to Q .90.]

Industrialization in colonial India represented a paradox of progress—an appearance of modernization concealing deep economic subordination. The British industrial revolution, powered by technological innovation and capitalist expansion, found in India both a vast market and a limitless source of raw materials. Yet, rather than fostering indigenous industrial growth, colonial policies deliberately stifled it. India, once renowned for its textile craftsmanship, saw its thriving handloom sector dismantled through a combination of tariff manipulation, import domination, and the flooding of British-manufactured goods. The railways, often celebrated as symbols of modernization, primarily served the colonial purpose of resource extraction and troop movement rather than national integration. Similarly, irrigation and infrastructure projects were designed less for agricultural welfare and more for enhancing revenue collection and export efficiency. The colonial economy thus functioned as an appendage to British industry — structured to benefit the

metropolis while impoverishing the colony. The decline of local industries displaced artisans and created widespread unemployment, while the agrarian population faced mounting land revenue demands and indebtedness. The resulting deindustrialization transformed India from a producer of finished goods to a supplier of raw materials like cotton, jute, and indigo. Even the emergence of Indian entrepreneurs in the late nineteenth century occurred within a highly restrictive framework that favored British capital. Industrial growth was permitted only when it aligned with imperial interests, reinforcing dependency rather than self-sufficiency. This economic pattern laid the foundation for structural inequalities that persisted long after independence. The rhetoric of “development” during colonial rule thus masked an exploitative design, where progress was measured not by Indian prosperity but by the profitability of the empire.

SSC CGL 17/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.86. What was the main objective of British industrial policy in India according to the passage ?

- (a) Promoting local entrepreneurship
- (b) Encouraging technological independence
- (c) Supporting British economic interests
- (d) Strengthening rural self-reliance

Q.87. What does the passage suggest about the railways under British rule ?

- (a) They were built primarily for social reform.
- (b) They aimed to enhance colonial control and extraction.
- (c) They unified India's diverse population.
- (d) They promoted village-level trade.

Q.88. The term “deindustrialization” in the passage refers to—

- (a) Growth of British manufacturing in India
- (b) The collapse of indigenous industries
- (c) The expansion of small-scale crafts
- (d) Introduction of modern machinery

Q.89. Why were Indian entrepreneurs limited in their success during colonial rule ?

- (a) They lacked technical knowledge
- (b) They faced an unsupportive domestic market
- (c) They operated within a biased system favoring British capital
- (d) They focused only on agriculture

Q.90. What long-term impact of colonial economic policy does the passage highlight ?

- (a) Industrial self-sufficiency after independence
- (b) Enduring structural economic inequalities
- (c) Rapid technological development
- (d) Decline of British influence in global trade

SET - 19 [Q .91. to Q .95.]

Air pollution has emerged as one of the gravest environmental challenges of the 21st century, particularly in rapidly urbanising regions of Asia and Africa. While economic expansion and urban growth have lifted millions out of poverty, they have also intensified the concentration of harmful pollutants such as particulate matter (PM2.5 and PM10), nitrogen oxides, carbon monoxide, and ground-level ozone. Unlike the visible soot and smog of the industrial revolution, today's pollution is more insidious, operating at a microscopic level and silently undermining human health and ecological stability. According to global health reports, prolonged exposure to fine particulate matter can cause chronic respiratory illnesses, cardiovascular

disorders, and even premature death. Yet, despite the well-documented consequences, policy responses often remain fragmented and reactive.

A systematic solution to the air quality crisis must begin with comprehensive monitoring. Many cities lack reliable, real-time data, making it difficult to identify pollution hotspots or enforce emission norms effectively. Expanding the network of air quality sensors and integrating satellite-based data can create a more accurate picture of pollution dynamics. This data-driven approach would allow authorities to implement targeted interventions rather than blanket restrictions.

Secondly, the transportation sector demands structural reform. Vehicular emissions constitute a major share of urban pollution. Promoting electric mobility through subsidies, expanding public transport, and improving last-mile connectivity can significantly cut tailpipe emissions. Simultaneously, strict inspection and maintenance regimes for older vehicles should be enforced to phase out the most polluting fleets.

Industrial emissions require equal attention. Establishing green industrial corridors, adopting cleaner production technologies, and introducing market-based mechanisms such as emission trading schemes can reduce the carbon and pollution footprint of manufacturing zones. Additionally, transitioning from coal to renewable energy sources like solar, wind, and bioenergy can gradually decouple economic growth from environmental harm. At the community level, awareness and behavioural change are indispensable. Citizens can contribute by reducing household waste burning, conserving energy, and supporting local green initiatives. Schools and civic bodies must incorporate environmental education to instil sustainable habits early on. Moreover, coordinated regional action is vital because air pollution does not respect administrative boundaries. Countries sharing airsheds—such as India, Bangladesh, and Nepal—must collaborate on emission inventories, early warning systems, and technology exchange.

In essence, clean air cannot be achieved through isolated efforts or temporary bans. It demands an integrated policy framework that combines technology, governance, public participation, and transnational cooperation. The air we breathe is a shared resource, and its protection requires a collective commitment to sustainability, accountability, and scientific precision.

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.91. Which of the following best describes the author's overall perspective on air pollution management?

- (a) It can be resolved through strict emergency measures.
- (b) It requires a comprehensive, data-driven, and collaborative approach.
- (c) It depends mainly on international financial assistance.
- (d) It should be left to technological innovation alone.

Q.92. What is identified as a key limitation in current air quality governance?

- (a) Excessive reliance on public awareness campaigns
- (b) Lack of accurate and continuous monitoring systems
- (c) Overproduction of renewable energy
- (d) High cost of electric vehicles

Q.93. How does the author propose to reduce vehicular emissions effectively?

- (a) By introducing more diesel-run public buses
- (b) By encouraging private car ownership
- (c) Through electric mobility, efficient public transport, and vehicle phase-outs

(d) By constructing more highways and flyovers

Q.94. What does the author suggest about public participation in air quality improvement?

- (a) It is secondary to technological interventions.
- (b) It can drive meaningful change through behavioural adjustments.
- (c) It is only effective during pollution emergencies.
- (d) It has little impact compared to industrial policies.

Q.95. Which statement reflects the author's view of the long-term solution to air pollution?

- (a) Strengthening short-term regulations
- (b) Clean air can be achieved only by halting industrial growth.
- (c) Coordinated regional policies and community engagement are crucial.
- (d) The issue can be addressed by focusing solely on local governance.

SET - 20 [Q .96. to Q .100.]

In an era dominated by digital interconnectivity, the concept of "truth" has undergone a profound transformation. Once anchored in verifiable facts and shared understanding, it now often floats within fragmented online realities shaped by algorithms and personal biases. The democratization of information—while seemingly empowering — has paradoxically made distinguishing fact from fiction increasingly difficult. Social media platforms, under the guise of free expression, amplify voices not by credibility but by engagement metrics. As a result, emotional intensity often outweighs evidence, and virality substitutes for validity.

The architecture of digital discourse rewards polarization; outrage generates clicks, and clicks generate profit. Consequently, misinformation thrives, spreading faster than verified facts. The modern individual, inundated by competing narratives, gravitates toward information that aligns with pre-existing beliefs—a psychological phenomenon known as confirmation bias. This creates parallel realities where objective truth becomes secondary to ideological comfort. News consumers are no longer passive recipients but active participants in shaping the narratives they wish to believe.

However, the problem is not technology itself but our uncritical dependence on it. Search engines and feeds, optimized for personalization, narrow our exposure to diverse perspectives. True digital literacy, therefore, lies not in constant connectivity but in critical awareness — questioning sources, examining intent, and embracing discomfort in confronting opposing viewpoints. Only through such self-reflection can individuals reclaim the integrity of truth in an age designed to distort it.

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.96. What is the central argument of the passage ?

- (a) Technology has replaced human judgment entirely
- (b) Truth in the digital age is shaped by algorithms and personal biases
- (c) Social media platforms are neutral spaces for free speech
- (d) The internet has reduced global communication barriers

Q.97. According to the passage, what drives the spread of misinformation online ?

- (a) Strict content moderation
- (b) The emotional and viral nature of online engagement
- (c) Lack of government regulation
- (d) A shortage of credible journalists

Q.98. What does the author suggest about confirmation bias?

- (a) It encourages exposure to new ideas
- (b) It makes people more open-minded
- (c) It causes individuals to seek information that supports their beliefs
- (d) It reduces online polarization

Q.99. What does the author identify as the essence of true digital literacy ?

- (a) Staying constantly updated on trending topics
- (b) Accepting online content without question
- (c) Critically analyzing information and opposing views
- (d) Relying on automated fact-checking tools

Q.100. Which tone best reflects the author's perspective ?

- (a) Critical and analytical
- (b) Humorous and casual
- (c) Pessimistic and despairing
- (d) Indifferent and detached

SET - 21 [Q .101. to Q .105.]

In an era defined by relentless technological acceleration, the concept of time has undergone a profound transformation. What was once a natural rhythm, guided by the alternation of day and night, has become an economic commodity subject to precision, measurement, and monetization. The Industrial Revolution marked the first decisive shift, synchronizing human activity with the ticking of the clock. Factory whistles replaced the crow of the rooster, and punctuality became a moral virtue. In the digital age, this commodification has intensified. Every moment is tracked, categorized, and optimized—an invisible currency traded in the global marketplace of attention.

Time management is no longer a simple skill but an ideological expectation that governs modern life. The lexicon of efficiency has infiltrated both professional and personal spheres, equating speed with intelligence and busyness with value. Leisure, once considered restorative, is now subtly framed as unproductive or even wasteful. The pressure to constantly perform, respond, and produce has eroded the capacity for stillness. Humanity's obsession with saving time paradoxically ensures that there is never enough of it.

This mechanized relationship with time breeds a deep psychological alienation.

The more individuals attempt to master time, the more subservient they become to its relentless quantification. Pre-industrial societies perceived time as cyclical and collective, attuned to the organic patterns of nature—the harvest, the tide, the moon. Time flowed with life, not against it. Today, however, the digital clock abstracts time from lived experience, rendering it uniform, fragmented, and detached from meaning. The day becomes a sequence of scheduled obligations rather than an unfolding of moments.

The age of hyper-connectivity has further distorted temporal perception. Instant communication fosters impatience; delayed responses evoke anxiety. The constant flow of notifications creates an illusion of perpetual urgency, where silence feels like a void that must be filled. This culture of immediacy undermines contemplation and depth. As philosopher Byung-Chul Han observes, "the contemplative pause" — once essential to creativity and understanding — is vanishing. Without it, thought becomes shallow, and relationships transactional.

To reclaim agency over time, humanity must reimagine it not as a resource to be spent but as a medium through which meaning, connection, and reflection emerge. Time, in its richest sense, is not a race against the clock but an art of presence — an act of inhabiting each moment fully. Only by learning to dwell, rather than to hurry, can we recover the lost harmony between time,

technology, and the self.

SSC CGL 18/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.101. Which of the following best expresses the central idea of the passage?

- (a) The passage warns against the economic exploitation of natural resources.
- (b) It examines how technological and social changes have commodified time and altered human experience.
- (c) It explores how pre-industrial societies failed to measure time accurately.
- (d) It argues that leisure and work should be treated as identical pursuits.

Q.102. What does the author mean by the statement, "Humanity's obsession with saving time paradoxically ensures that there is never enough of it" ?

- (a) Saving time allows people to be more productive.
- (b) The more people try to optimize time, the more they feel deprived of it.
- (c) People have stopped measuring time altogether.
- (d) The industrial era made time infinite and abundant.

Q.103. According to the passage, how did pre-industrial societies experience time differently from modern societies?

- (a) They ignored time completely and lived without schedules.
- (b) They perceived time as cyclical and harmonious with nature rather than mechanical and fragmented.
- (c) They used more accurate systems for tracking time.
- (d) They prioritized personal ambition over collective harmony.

Q.104. What does the passage imply about the effect of hyper-connectivity on human behavior?

- (a) It strengthens patience and long-term focus.
- (b) It fosters calm reflection and silence.
- (c) It creates impatience, anxiety, and a constant sense of urgency.
- (d) It restores the contemplative rhythm of life.

Q.105. Which of the following best captures the author's proposed remedy for modern alienation from time?

- (a) Strictly limiting the use of digital technology.
- (b) Increasing productivity through better time management techniques.
- (c) Reimagining time as a space for presence, reflection, and meaning rather than as a commodity.
- (d) Returning to pre-industrial methods of labor and agriculture.

SET - 22 [Q .106. to Q .110.]

Justice and equality, though often invoked together, are distinct yet interdependent ideals that form the backbone of any democratic society. Justice concerns itself with fairness — ensuring that individuals receive what they are due, based on merit, need, or equity. Equality, on the other hand, demands that all individuals be treated the same, without discrimination or privilege. However, absolute equality can sometimes undermine justice, just as rigid notions of justice may perpetuate inequality. For instance, providing identical resources to students from vastly different socio-economic backgrounds may appear equal but fails to be just, as it ignores contextual disadvantages. Hence, modern social theorists argue for "equity" — a dynamic balance that considers differences without abandoning fairness. Philosophers from Aristotle to Rawls have grappled with this tension. Aristotle viewed justice as giving each person their due, emphasizing proportional fairness rather than sameness.

Centuries later, John Rawls introduced the "veil of ignorance" — a thought experiment suggesting that just principles are those chosen without knowing one's social status. His theory underscored that true fairness must protect the least advantaged, not merely maintain formal equality. However, translating such philosophical ideals into public policy is rarely straightforward. Bureaucratic systems often reduce nuanced principles into rigid procedures, where equality is measured by uniform rules rather than outcomes. The digital age adds another layer to this debate. Algorithms used in hiring, lending, or law enforcement claim objectivity but often reproduce existing biases encoded in data. A recruitment system that screens candidates purely on "neutral" data may still discriminate against marginalized groups, revealing how equality in process does not always yield justice in result. Therefore, achieving a just society demands constant reflection — to move beyond mechanical equality and toward fairness rooted in empathy, adaptability, and moral imagination.

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.106. What main distinction does the passage draw between justice and equality ?

- (a) Justice is about fairness, while equality ensures sameness in treatment.
- (b) Equality focuses on merit, while justice ignores it.
- (c) Both are identical in democratic societies.
- (d) Equality is more important than justice.

Q.107. Why does the author mention Aristotle and Rawls?

- (a) To show how philosophers disagreed on democracy.
- (b) To highlight historical and modern perspectives on justice.
- (c) To criticize ancient philosophical theories.
- (d) To argue that equality has always been superior to justice.

Q.108. According to the passage, what problem arises from bureaucratic implementation of justice?

- (a) It becomes excessively fair.
- (b) It simplifies complex ideas into rigid procedures.
- (c) It eliminates inequality entirely.
- (d) It prioritizes empathy over order.

Q.109. What concern does the author raise about algorithms in modern systems?

- (a) They always promote equality and justice.
- (b) They remove all forms of bias.
- (c) They can perpetuate hidden biases under the guise of neutrality.
- (d) They are too costly to implement.

Q.110. What is the passage's overall message regarding equality and justice?

- (a) Societies must pursue fairness that adapts to context rather than mechanical equality.
- (b) Justice is less important than maintaining equal rules.
- (c) Equality should never be questioned.
- (d) Philosophical reflection has no practical value.

SET - 23 [Q .111. to Q .115.]

In an age characterized by constant connection and excessive information, the idea of being alone has become both rare and vital. Rather than being the same as loneliness, solitude signifies a mindful retreat—a purposeful effort to recover mental clarity and inner calm. Throughout history, thinkers, writers, and inventors have sought time in seclusion as a means for profound thought and invention. In solitude, the mind is free

from social expectations, allowing ideas to form in their pure and unfiltered state. Yet today, solitude is often misunderstood, seen as unproductive or antisocial. The dominance of digital interaction has weakened our ability to spend time alone, replacing self-reflection with continuous stimulation. Messages, feeds, and the reward loop of online approval sustain a cycle of distraction that divides focus and reduces awareness.

On a psychological level, being alone provides a moment for emotional balance. It allows people to interpret their experiences without the pressure of comparison or approval. Scientific studies indicate that deliberate solitude activates the brain's resting network, connected to memory, identity, and imagination. Interestingly, individuals who regularly spend time alone often show stronger empathy and social connection, as they engage with others from a stable sense of self rather than dependence. Culturally, however, the glorification of busyness and constant activity has made solitude seem unusual. Communities that measure value by output tend to ignore the restorative role of stillness. Regaining solitude, therefore, requires both structural and personal adjustments—defining achievement not only by what one does but also by what one understands. True solitude is not withdrawal, but integration: a reunion with one's own thoughts and purpose. In the quiet of being alone, one does not avoid the world but learns to face it with renewed insight.

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.111. Select the most appropriate antonym of “restorative” as per the given sentence from the passage:

Communities that measure value by output tend to ignore the restorative role of stillness.

- (a) Energizing (b) Refreshing (c) Exhausting (d) Healing

Q.112. According to the passage, how does solitude contribute to emotional health?

- (a) By isolating people from social judgment.
(b) By encouraging suppression of emotions.
(c) By helping individuals process experiences calmly and clearly.
(d) By promoting dependence on external validation.

Q.113. What does the passage imply about people who spend time alone intentionally?

- (a) They become detached from society.
(b) They tend to develop stronger empathy and self-awareness.
(c) They lose interest in meaningful relationships.
(d) They struggle to maintain emotional balance.

Q.114. The passage suggests that modern culture undervalues solitude because it:

- (a) Emphasizes personal growth and learning.
(b) Promotes collective well-being over individual thought.
(c) Encourages self-reflection and emotional understanding.
(d) Equates success mainly with productivity and visible activity.

Q.115. What is the main reason the passage gives for society's decreasing ability to experience solitude?

- (a) Increased loneliness and emotional withdrawal.
(b) Overreliance on digital communication and constant stimulation.
(c) A decline in individual creativity and imagination.
(d) Growing interest in social and cultural interaction.

SET - 24 [Q .116. to Q .120.]

The debate on environmental sustainability in India reflects the tension between economic aspirations and ecological realities.

As one of the fastest-growing major economies, India faces the dual challenge of maintaining growth while mitigating environmental degradation. Government policies often highlight the rhetoric of green development, yet implementation remains inconsistent. Industrial expansion, urbanization, and energy demands continue to strain natural ecosystems. Air and water pollution, deforestation, and waste mismanagement have become defining features of modern India's development narrative. The irony lies in the fact that while technological progress promises efficiency, it simultaneously accelerates ecological imbalance when pursued without ethical and environmental accountability. Rural communities, though less industrialized, face their own environmental dilemmas. Agricultural dependency makes them highly vulnerable to climate variability—erratic monsoons, declining groundwater levels, and soil infertility directly threaten livelihoods. The push for chemical-intensive farming has yielded short-term gains but at the cost of long-term sustainability. Meanwhile, urban centers confront a different crisis: unplanned construction, vehicular emissions, and mounting e-waste. The social consequences are profound—rising health issues, displacement of marginalized populations, and widening inequality between those who can “buy” clean air and those who cannot. Public awareness and activism have grown through digital media, judicial interventions, and youth-led climate movements. Yet, a significant portion of society still views environmental protection as secondary to economic growth. The cultural mindset that equates development solely with industrialization must evolve. Environmental stewardship should not be perceived as an obstacle but as an investment in the nation's longevity. True sustainability, the author argues, requires a paradigm shift—from reactive regulation to proactive ecological consciousness. Without this transformation, India's pursuit of progress risks undermining the very foundation it depends upon: a habitable planet.

SSC CGL 19/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.116. What core tension does the passage highlight in India's development model?

- (a) Urban versus rural employment
(b) Economic growth versus environmental sustainability
(c) Population growth versus education
(d) Industrialization versus agriculture

Q.117. According to the passage, what is a key reason for environmental degradation despite policy initiatives?

- (a) Lack of awareness among farmers
(b) Weak implementation of green policies
(c) Decline in population growth
(d) Overdependence on foreign aid

Q.118. What environmental issue primarily affects rural communities, as mentioned in the passage?

- (a) Industrial pollution
(b) E-waste generation
(c) Climate variability impacting agriculture
(d) Traffic congestion

Q.119. What irony does the author identify regarding technological progress?

- (a) It reduces energy demand drastically
(b) It improves employment opportunities
(c) It promotes equality across classes
(d) It advances development but worsens ecological imbalance

Q.120. What long-term solution does the author advocate for



achieving sustainability ?

- (a) Stricter industrial regulations only
- (b) A shift toward ecological awareness and responsible mindset
- (c) Increased foreign investment in energy
- (d) Temporary bans on urban construction

SET - 25 [Q .121. to Q .125.]

In the digital age, personal data has become one of the most valuable commodities, shaping how businesses, governments, and individuals interact. Every online search, social media post, and mobile transaction contributes to a vast ecosystem of data collection and analysis. Tech giants employ sophisticated algorithms to track user preferences, predict behavior, and deliver personalized advertisements that seem almost intuitive. While this data-driven world enhances convenience and efficiency, it simultaneously exposes individuals to unprecedented privacy risks. The boundaries between public and private life are blurring as personal information becomes a tradable asset, often exchanged without informed consent. Governments argue that surveillance technologies are essential for national security and public safety, yet the same tools can be misused to monitor citizens, suppress dissent, or manipulate elections. Data breaches and unauthorized access to confidential information have become alarmingly frequent, eroding public trust in digital institutions. In many cases, users agree to complex privacy policies they barely read, granting corporations sweeping rights over their data in exchange for “free” services. This imbalance of power raises critical ethical questions: Who truly owns personal data? How much control should individuals retain over their digital footprints? Addressing these concerns requires a multi-dimensional approach. Stronger data protection laws, such as the European Union’s General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), aim to empower users by ensuring transparency and consent. Similarly, initiatives in India like the Digital Personal Data Protection Act seek to safeguard citizens’ privacy while enabling responsible innovation. However, legislation alone cannot solve the problem. Public awareness, ethical corporate behavior, and the promotion of digital literacy are equally vital. As technology continues to evolve—from facial recognition to artificial intelligence—the ethical use of data will determine the future of digital democracy. Ultimately, privacy in the 21st century is not just a legal right but a fundamental expression of personal autonomy, dignity, and freedom in an interconnected world

SSC CGL 20/09/2025 (Shift 2).

Q.121. According to the passage, what makes personal data highly valuable in the modern world?

- (a) It improves entertainment quality
- (b) It helps predict and influence human behavior
- (c) It reduces government expenditure
- (d) It prevents technological misuse

Q.122. What primary risk accompanies the rise of data-driven technologies?

- (a) Lack of mobile connectivity (b) Increase in hardware costs
- (c) Invasion of individual privacy (d) Decline in global trade

Q.123. What ethical question does the author raise regarding digital data?

- (a) Should governments own all private data?
- (b) Who truly owns personal data and controls its use?
- (c) How can data storage be made cheaper?
- (d) Should social media be banned?

Q.124. What role do laws like GDPR and India’s Digital Personal Data Protection Act play?

- (a) They encourage online advertising
- (b) They safeguard user privacy through consent and transparency
- (c) They limit internet access in developing countries
- (d) They ban global technology companies

Q.125. What does the author identify as essential beyond legislation for ensuring privacy ?

- (a) Stricter surveillance
- (b) Digital literacy and ethical corporate conduct
- (c) Reducing technological use
- (d) Censorship of online media

SET - 26 [Q .126. to Q .130.]

Deep beneath the ocean’s surface lies one of the least explored frontiers on Earth — the abyssal plain. Stretching across vast regions of the seabed, these flat, dark expanses are home to an array of organisms uniquely adapted to conditions of crushing pressure, perpetual darkness, and scarce food supply. Life here thrives not on sunlight but on chemical energy derived from hydrothermal vents, where mineral-rich fluids gush from the Earth’s crust. Around these vents, chemosynthetic bacteria form the foundation of an entire ecosystem, sustaining giant tube worms, blind shrimp, and specialised crabs.

The discovery of these vent-based ecosystems in the late 20th century revolutionised our understanding of life itself, challenging the long-held notion that sunlight was essential for biological productivity. The study of such organisms has also deepened scientific insight into possible extraterrestrial life, particularly on icy moons like Europa and Enceladus, where similar energy sources may exist beneath frozen crusts. Yet, the growing interest in deep-sea mining threatens to disturb these fragile habitats. Extraction of minerals such as cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements could irreversibly damage ecosystems that have taken millennia to evolve. Scientists urge that conservation and research must precede exploitation, ensuring that curiosity does not turn into destruction.

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.126. What role do hydrothermal vents play in the deep-sea ecosystem ?

- (a) They act as shelters for marine creatures.
- (b) They supply mineral-rich fluids that support chemosynthetic life.
- (c) They provide oxygen for photosynthetic organisms.
- (d) They function as geological traps for sediments.

Q.127. Which scientific assumption was challenged by the discovery of vent-based life forms?

- (a) Life cannot exist without sunlight.
- (b) Chemical energy is unimportant in biology.
- (c) Deep-sea exploration is impossible.
- (d) Only land organisms use minerals for energy.

Q.128. Why does the author caution against deep-sea mining ?

- (a) It could cause pollution in coastal waters.
- (b) It threatens to destroy delicate and ancient ecosystems.
- (c) It produces insufficient economic benefit.
- (d) It interferes with undersea communication cables.

Q.129. What is the closest meaning of the term ‘chemosynthetic’ in the passage?

- (a) Using light energy to make food

- (b) Depending on decayed organic matter
- (c) Producing food through chemical reactions
- (d) Feeding on other organisms

Q.130. Which statement best summarises the central idea of the passage ?

- (a) Deep-sea mining is necessary for technological progress.
- (b) Life in the ocean depths depends on sunlight and photosynthesis.
- (c) The abyssal plain hosts unique ecosystems that rely on chemical energy and need protection.
- (d) Marine organisms are easily adaptable to environmental changes.

SET - 27 [Q .131. to Q .135.]

The chronicles of polar exploration mirror humanity's insatiable curiosity to conquer the unknown. From the perilous expeditions of Roald Amundsen and Robert Falcon Scott in the early 20th century to the scientific missions of today, each journey to the Arctic and Antarctic regions has been a study in courage, endurance, and discovery. The polar explorers of the past braved unimaginable conditions—biting winds, perpetual darkness, and isolation—to map territories that defied comprehension. For them, exploration was not only geographical but existential: a confrontation with nature's extremities and with their own limitations.

In the modern era, the purpose of polar exploration has shifted. Once motivated by conquest and national prestige, contemporary missions focus on climate research, biodiversity preservation, and understanding Earth's fragile cryosphere. Satellite imagery and advanced instrumentation have replaced dog sleds and sextants, yet the underlying spirit of discovery persists. The ice continues to conceal both mysteries of the past and warnings for the future, reminding humanity that exploration, in its truest sense, is an act of stewardship as much as ambition.

SSC CGL 21/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.131. Which of the following best captures the author's tone throughout the passage?

- (a) Critical and dismissive
- (b) Analytical yet reverent
- (c) Sarcastic and humorous
- (d) Detached and indifferent

Q.132. The word "cryosphere" as used in the passage refers to:

- (a) The frozen parts of Earth's surface such as glaciers and polar ice caps
- (b) The upper layers of Earth's atmosphere
- (c) Regions affected by volcanic activity
- (d) The underwater zones near the equator

Q.133. In the clause "each journey to the Arctic and Antarctic regions has been a study in courage, endurance, and discovery," what is the function of the phrase "in courage, endurance, and discovery"?

- (a) It acts as an adverbial phrase of manner.
- (b) It functions as an adjective modifying "journey."
- (c) It serves as a prepositional phrase showing respect.
- (d) It acts as a complement explaining the kind of study.

Q.134. What shift in purpose does the passage identify between early and modern polar expeditions ?

- (a) From scientific observation to commercial gain
- (b) From exploration for conquest to exploration for environmental understanding
- (c) From adventure tourism to military control

- (d) From isolation to technological recreation

Q.135. What is the most appropriate meaning of the word "stewardship" in the final line ?

- (a) Ownership and control
- (b) Careful management and responsibility
- (c) Passive observation
- (d) Heroic dominance

SET - 28 [Q .136. to Q .140.]

Nutrition is the process by which living organisms obtain the food necessary for growth, metabolism, and other vital functions. It encompasses a vast array of biochemical and physiological processes, beginning with ingestion and culminating in the assimilation of nutrients at the cellular level. Macronutrients – carbohydrates, proteins, and fats – are required in larger quantities as they provide the bulk of energy and building blocks for bodily structures. Carbohydrates are the body's primary energy source, proteins are crucial for tissue repair and enzyme production, while fats are essential for hormone production, nutrient absorption, and organ protection. Micronutrients, though needed in smaller amounts, are equally indispensable. These include vitamins and minerals, which play pivotal roles in myriad enzymatic reactions, immune function, and overall cellular health. For instance, Vitamin C is vital for collagen synthesis and immune support, while iron is central to oxygen transport in the blood. A deficiency in any micronutrient can lead to specific health issues, ranging from mild impairments to severe diseases.

The concept of a "balanced diet" is foundational to good nutrition, advocating for a diverse intake of foods from all major food groups to ensure adequate provision of both macronutrients and micronutrients. However, modern dietary patterns, often characterized by highly processed foods, excessive sugar, and unhealthy fats, frequently deviate from this ideal. These imbalances contribute significantly to the global burden of non-communicable diseases, such as obesity, type 2 diabetes, and cardiovascular disease. Understanding the intricate relationship between diet and health empowers individuals to make informed choices, fostering well-being and preventing chronic illness. Educating the public on nutritional science is, therefore, a crucial public health endeavour.

SSC CGL 22/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.136. What are the three main macronutrients required by the human body ?

- (a) Vitamins, minerals, and water
- (b) Carbohydrates, proteins, and fats
- (c) Sugar, salt, and fiber
- (d) Enzymes, hormones, and cells

Q.137. Why are micronutrients considered indispensable, even though they are needed in smaller amounts ?

- (a) They provide the body's primary energy source.
- (b) They are crucial for tissue repair and enzyme production.
- (c) They play pivotal roles in enzymatic reactions, immune function, and cellular health.
- (d) They are essential for hormone production and organ protection.

Q.138. What is a key characteristic of modern dietary patterns, according to the passage ?

- (a) A focus on balanced intake from all food groups.
- (b) High consumption of fruits and vegetables.
- (c) Frequent deviation from a balanced diet with processed

- foods and excessive sugar.
(d) An increased understanding of nutritional science.

Q.139. What is the primary role of carbohydrates mentioned in the passage?

- (a) Tissue repair. (b) Hormone production.
(c) Oxygen transport. (d) Body's primary energy source.

Q.140. What can a deficiency in any micronutrient lead to?

- (a) Increased energy levels.
(b) Stronger immune function.
(c) Specific health issues, from mild impairments to severe diseases.
(d) Excess weight gain.

SET - 29 [Q .141. to Q .145.]

The prospect of establishing permanent human settlements on Mars, once relegated to the pages of science fiction, is increasingly viewed as a tangible objective, driven by rapid technological advances and commercial ambitions. Mars, the fourth planet from the Sun, represents both an unprecedented opportunity for scientific discovery and a formidable challenge for human survival. Programs led by NASA, in tandem with private enterprises like SpaceX, aim to send humans to the Red Planet within the next few decades, with the goal of creating sustainable habitats. Central to these missions are technologies such as advanced life-support systems, radiation shielding, autonomous energy production, and in-situ resource utilization, which includes converting subsurface water ice into potable water, breathable oxygen, and fuel for return journeys. Yet, the Martian environment remains harsh and inhospitable: extreme temperature fluctuations, low atmospheric pressure, high radiation levels, and the psychological strain of isolation pose significant obstacles. In addition, the legal framework governing extraterrestrial property remains ambiguous, raising questions about private and commercial rights as corporations increasingly invest in Martian ventures. Despite these challenges, the combination of international collaboration, public investment, and private innovation steadily moves humanity closer to realizing the dream of interplanetary habitation. While fully self-sufficient colonies may remain decades away, the scientific, technological, and political groundwork is steadily aligning, making the notion of living on Mars increasingly plausible.

SSC CGL 23/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.141. What does the author imply by "increasingly viewed as a tangible objective"?

- (a) Mars colonization is impossible
(b) Mars exploration is a distant dream
(c) Mars colonization is becoming realistic
(d) Mars is already fully inhabited

Q.142. What is the main utility of subsurface water ice on Mars as per the paragraph ?

- (a) Cooling habitats
(b) Converting into water, oxygen, and fuel
(c) Supporting plant growth
(d) Creating a magnetic field

Q.143. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge for Martian habitation ?

- (a) Extreme temperature fluctuations (b) High radiation levels
(c) Lack of breathable atmosphere (d) Martian flora and fauna

Q.144. Which program or enterprise is associated with sending

humans to Mars?

- (a) Chandrayaan (b) SpaceX (c) Artemis (d) Chang'e

Q.145. Why does the author mention legal ambiguities regarding extraterrestrial property ?

- (a) To highlight commercial and ownership concerns
(b) To encourage international scientific cooperation
(c) To emphasize astronaut safety
(d) To restrict travel to Mars

SET - 30 [Q .146. to Q .150.]

Language, as a living system, mirrors the evolution of human society, thought, and culture. It constantly adapts to new contexts, reflecting the values and innovations of each era. Unlike static symbols, words possess an inherent flexibility that allows them to gain fresh meanings, discard outdated ones, and reshape themselves to suit changing human experiences. The rise of digital communication has accelerated this linguistic evolution, blending written and spoken forms in unprecedented ways. Abbreviations, emojis, and informal expressions have become integral to modern communication, reshaping how people convey tone, emotion, and nuance. While some view these shifts as a decline in linguistic standards or a threat to grammatical purity, others interpret them as evidence of language's vitality. The continual adaptation of vocabulary and structure illustrates that language, far from weakening, grows stronger through innovation. Just as societies evolve to meet new realities, so too does language transform to reflect technological, cultural, and emotional developments. Its strength lies not in resisting change but in absorbing it, ensuring that communication remains meaningful and relevant across generations. Ultimately, language endures because it mirrors the adaptability of the human mind itself, always seeking new ways to express thought and connection.

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.146. Which of the following best expresses the central idea of the passage ?

- (a) Language must remain unchanged to preserve its cultural value.
(b) The flexibility of language allows it to survive and stay relevant.
(c) Digital communication has weakened the purpose of language.
(d) Words should retain their original meanings to ensure clarity.

Q.147. According to the passage, how has digital communication influenced language ?

- (a) It has restricted the creative use of words.
(b) It has made written and spoken language more distinct.
(c) It has blended written and spoken forms through new symbols and abbreviations.
(d) It has eliminated the need for grammar and structure.

Q.148. What does the author imply by stating that "language mirrors the adaptability of the human mind" ?

- (a) Language changes only when people change their values.
(b) Language evolves because humans are capable of innovation and flexibility.
(c) Language follows strict, unchanging rules of human thought.
(d) Language adapts automatically without human involvement.

Q.149. The phrase "linguistic purity" as used in the passage refers to:

- (a) Maintaining traditional forms and avoiding modern variations.

- (b) Encouraging creativity in communication.
- (c) Using a mix of languages and expressions.
- (d) Promoting simplicity in speech.

Q.150. Which of the following words best describes the author's attitude toward linguistic change ?

- (a) Critical (b) Appreciative (c) Indifferent (d) Pessimistic

SET - 31 [Q .151. to Q .155.]

Self-improvement is often misunderstood as a relentless pursuit of productivity, but its essence lies in conscious evolution rather than constant acceleration. Genuine growth involves introspection—the ability to assess one's values, patterns, and limitations without defensiveness. Many individuals equate self-betterment with acquiring new skills or achieving external milestones, yet transformation begins internally. Recognising one's thought habits and emotional triggers often precedes any lasting behavioural change. Another key dimension of self-improvement is consistency. Grand resolutions may generate temporary enthusiasm, but small, repeated actions cultivate real progress. This is because repetition strengthens neural pathways, turning intentional effort into natural behaviour. Equally important is self-compassion. Improvement that stems from self-criticism usually breeds anxiety, whereas a kind and patient attitude toward one's imperfections encourages resilience and persistence. Furthermore, self-improvement is a cyclical process—it requires periodic reflection and recalibration rather than linear progression. By accepting setbacks as feedback rather than evidence of failure, individuals remain adaptable and motivated. Ultimately, authentic self-improvement is not about becoming someone else, but about aligning one's daily choices more closely with one's deeper values and aspirations.

SSC CGL 24/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.151. Select the most appropriate synonym of the word "introspection" as used in the passage.

- (a) Observation (b) Self-examination
- (c) Comparison (d) Evaluation of others

Q.152. According to the author, why are small, repeated actions more effective than grand resolutions?

- (a) They require less time and commitment
- (b) They gradually rewire mental patterns and habits
- (c) They ensure instant visible results
- (d) They eliminate the need for reflection

Q.153. What attitude does the passage recommend when dealing with personal flaws?

- (a) Harsh criticism to maintain discipline
- (b) Complete indifference to mistakes
- (c) Gentle self-compassion and patience
- (d) Avoidance of introspection

Q.154. How does the passage describe the nature of the self-improvement journey ?

- (a) As a straight path from weakness to strength
- (b) As a circular process of learning and adjustment
- (c) As a competitive race against time
- (d) As an occasional need during crises

Q.155. What central idea is conveyed in the final sentence of the passage?

- (a) True growth is achieved by imitating others' success
- (b) Improvement is about authenticity and alignment with one's values

- (c) Self-improvement requires abandoning old identities completely
- (d) Personal change depends entirely on external achievements

SET - 32 [Q .156. to Q .160.]

The concept of environmental stewardship encompasses more than mere conservation; it represents a proactive commitment to sustaining the biosphere through ethical engagement, scientific insight, and social responsibility. Ecosystems, as intricate networks of interdependent species and abiotic factors, demonstrate that ecological stability is contingent upon balance rather than domination. Historically, human societies that harmonized their activities with natural rhythms—through agrarian practices, sacred groves, or community-managed water systems—exemplified resilience and sustainability. Conversely, extractive exploitation, often justified by short-term gains, has repeatedly led to biodiversity loss, soil degradation, and climate vulnerability. Philosophically, environmental stewardship interrogates anthropocentric paradigms, challenging the assumption that human needs automatically supersede ecological thresholds. By cultivating ecological empathy, it promotes a recognition of intrinsic value in nonhuman life and a duty of care that transcends utilitarian calculus. On a sociopolitical level, stewardship manifests through legislation, policy frameworks, and civic initiatives that prioritize environmental justice. Yet, token gestures such as symbolic tree-planting campaigns or eco-certifications without systemic reform risk being performative, masking persistent environmental inequities. Economically, environmental stewardship drives innovation in renewable energy, sustainable agriculture, and circular economies. Diverse stakeholder engagement—from local communities to multinational corporations—enhances adaptive capacity and problem-solving, demonstrating that ecological responsibility and economic vitality are not mutually exclusive. In an era marked by climate crisis and rapid urbanization, the imperative to sustain ecological diversity is both urgent and complex. Stewardship, therefore, is not merely a technical practice; it is an ethical and existential orientation, underscoring humanity's intertwined fate with the natural world.

SSC CGL 25/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.156. What is the central philosophical significance of environmental stewardship as described in the passage?

- (a) It guarantees economic growth at all costs.
- (b) It prioritizes human dominance over natural systems.
- (c) It challenges anthropocentric assumptions and fosters ecological empathy.
- (d) It eliminates the need for social responsibility.

Q.157. The term "performative gestures" in the passage most closely refers to:

- (a) Actions that genuinely restore ecological balance.
- (b) Superficial acts that obscure deeper environmental problems.
- (c) Policies that redistribute natural resources equitably.
- (d) Scientific experiments that track biodiversity.

Q.158. How does the passage describe the economic importance of environmental stewardship?

- (a) By creating localized markets for traditional resources.
- (b) By encouraging extractive exploitation for short-term profit.
- (c) By promoting innovation and adaptive problem-solving through diverse engagement.
- (d) By reducing ecological regulation to maximize industrial

output.

Q.159. What does the phrase "intertwined fate with the natural world" most nearly imply?

- (a) Humans are independent of environmental conditions.
- (b) Human well-being is inseparable from ecological health.
- (c) Nature should be controlled for social stability.
- (d) Environmental outcomes are predetermined and unavoidable.

Q.160. According to the passage, historical societies that practiced environmental stewardship:

- (a) Focused on rapid industrial expansion.
- (b) Maintained resilience by aligning human activity with ecological balance.
- (c) Exploited ecosystems for immediate economic gain.
- (d) Developed purely technological solutions to environmental problems.

SET - 33 [Q .161. to Q .165.]

Once dismissed as a hobby for tech enthusiasts, podcasting has evolved into a sophisticated and highly strategic medium for both entertainment and professional communication. Beyond the casual image of informal chats, successful podcasters must negotiate an intricate ecosystem of audio production quality, listener analytics, content licensing, sponsorship deals, and social media amplification.

The accessibility of podcasting seemingly offers an egalitarian platform – anyone with a microphone can, in principle, reach a global audience. Yet, the reality is considerably more selective. Sustained success requires not only compelling storytelling but also expertise in audio editing, marketing strategies, audience engagement, and trend analysis. Regular scheduling, careful interaction with listeners, and adaptation to changes in distribution policies have become essential competencies.

Moreover, the psychological consequences of relying on listener metrics for professional validation cannot be overlooked. Podcasters frequently face stress, performance anxiety, and fluctuating motivation. Unlike conventional employment, the field offers minimal institutional support; creators must independently negotiate contracts, manage finances, and address health considerations.

Nonetheless, for those who can navigate this challenging terrain, the rewards are substantial – creatively and financially. The medium allows exceptional independence, providing a direct channel between the creator and the audience, largely free from traditional editorial oversight. In a rapidly evolving media landscape, podcasting represents more than a passing fad; it signals a transformation in how content is produced, distributed, and consumed.

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.161. Identify the grammatical function of the phrase "providing a direct channel between the creator and the audience" in the sentence:

"The medium allows exceptional independence, providing a direct channel between the creator and the audience, largely free from traditional editorial oversight."

- (a) Adjective phrase
- (b) Present participial phrase functioning as an adverb
- (c) Noun phrase acting as an object
- (d) Absolute phrase modifying the subject

Q.162. In the sentence "Beyond the casual image of informal chats, successful podcasters must negotiate an intricate

ecosystem of audio production quality, listener analytics..."

What is the function of the introductory phrase "Beyond the casual image of informal chats"?

- (a) Appositive phrase
- (b) Adverbial phrase modifying "must negotiate"
- (c) Prepositional phrase functioning as a noun
- (d) Absolute phrase with implied verb

Q.163. What is the closest meaning of the word "intricate" as used in the passage?

- (a) Simple and straightforward
- (b) Complex and detailed
- (c) Predictable and repetitive
- (d) Superficial and careless

Q.164. Choose the most appropriate antonym for the word "egalitarian" as used in the passage.

- (a) Exclusive
- (b) Democratic
- (c) Inclusive
- (d) Accessible

Q.165. Which of the following best captures the primary tension described in the passage ?

- (a) The tension between casual perception of podcasting and the professional demands of the field
- (b) The tension between sponsorship deals and creative freedom
- (c) The tension between global audiences and local content restrictions
- (d) The tension between audio quality and listener engagement

SET - 34 [Q .166. to Q .170.]

The human lymphatic system plays a crucial role in maintaining internal balance by transporting excess fluid, filtering harmful substances, and supporting immune responses. Unlike the circulatory system, the lymphatic network does not rely on a central pump; instead, it depends on muscle movement and pressure changes to propel lymph throughout the body. Lymph nodes, positioned strategically along lymphatic vessels, act as biological checkpoints where pathogens are identified and neutralised.

Disruptions in this system can lead to a condition known as lymphoedema, characterised by abnormal fluid accumulation and persistent swelling, usually in the limbs. Left unmanaged, lymphoedema may impair mobility and increase susceptibility to infections. Early diagnosis is therefore essential, as timely intervention can significantly slow the progression of symptoms. Health experts emphasise that regular physical activity, adequate hydration, and proper limb care all contribute to a healthier lymphatic function. Additionally, avoiding tight clothing, which may restrict lymph flow, helps maintain natural circulation. As awareness grows, individuals are encouraged to monitor changes in their body and seek guidance whenever swelling or discomfort persists.

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.166. What does the term "accumulation" imply when dealing with lymphoedema ?

- (a) Removal of excess tissue
- (b) Gradual build-up of fluid
- (c) Sudden loss of pressure
- (d) Reduction in immune activity

Q.167. Select the most appropriate meaning of the term "susceptibility" as used in the passage.

- (a) Strong resistance to illness
- (b) Increased likelihood of being affected
- (c) Complete immunity from infection
- (d) Ability to recover instantly

Q.168. Select the correct part of speech to fill in the blank.

"Lymph nodes act as biological checkpoints where harmful____are detected and neutralised."

- (a) invade (b) invaded (c) invaders (d) invading

Q.169. According to the passage, which practice supports healthy lymphatic function ?

- (a) Wearing tight clothing to stabilise the limbs
(b) Remaining physically inactive to reduce strain
(c) Drinking enough water and staying active
(d) Ignoring swelling unless it becomes painful

Q.170. Fill in the blank with the correct relative pronoun.

"The lymphatic system lacks a central pump, _____ makes muscle movement essential for fluid transport."

- (a) which (b) why (c) how (d) what

SET - 35 [Q .171. to Q .175.]

The evolution of aviation has profoundly transformed human mobility, redefining perceptions of distance and time. Initial attempts, such as Leonardo da Vinci's conceptual sketches and 18th-century hot air balloons, provided rudimentary insights into the principles of flight but were largely experimental. It was the Wright brothers, with their powered Flyer in 1903, who truly demonstrated controlled, sustained flight, ushering in the era of modern aviation.

The 20th century witnessed rapid advancements: piston-engine planes evolved into jet aircraft, dramatically enhancing speed, range, and payload capacities. Milestones such as the introduction of supersonic transport, epitomized by Concorde in 1976, symbolized human ingenuity in overcoming aerodynamic and engineering challenges. Today, innovations like autonomous drones and electric aircraft aim to revolutionize both commercial and military aviation, promising enhanced efficiency and sustainability.

Yet, beyond technological marvels, airplanes have reshaped societies, enabling globalization, cultural exchange, and economic interconnectivity. The chronicle of aviation progress illustrates a continuous pursuit of mastery over the skies, where each transformative innovation mirrors broader patterns of human curiosity, ambition, and adaptation.

SSC CGL 26/09/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.171. Identify the tense and voice used in the sentence:

"It was the Wright brothers, with their powered Flyer in 1903, who truly demonstrated controlled, sustained flight..."

- (a) Past Perfect Active (b) Simple Past Active
(c) Present Perfect Passive (d) Past Continuous Passive

Q.172. What grammatical function does the phrase "epitomized by Concorde in 1976" serve in the sentence:

"Milestones such as the introduction of supersonic transport, epitomized by Concorde in 1976, symbolized human ingenuity..."

- (a) Adjective phrase modifying "supersonic transport"
(b) Adverbial phrase explaining time
(c) Noun clause functioning as subject
(d) Gerund phrase acting as object

Q.173. In the passage, what is the closest meaning of the word "ushering" in:

- (a) Ignoring (b) Introducing (c) Halting (d) Observing

Q.174. What is the meaning of the word "transformative" as used in:

"The evolution of aviation has profoundly transformed human mobility, redefining perceptions of distance and time."

- (a) Ordinary (b) Temporary
(c) Highly significant and altering (d) Repetitive

Q.175. Which of the following best captures the overall tone of the passage?

- (a) Nostalgic and critical (b) Analytical and celebratory
(c) Indifferent and factual (d) Alarmist and skeptical

Solutions :-

SET - 1

Sol.1.(b) The study of gene expression without changing DNA.

The passage states, "epigenetics reveals that environmental factors... can profoundly influence gene expression without altering the underlying DNA code." This clearly identifies the main focus.

Sol.2.(b) They turn genes on or off.

The passage says these modifications "act as molecular switches, turning genes on or off, or modulating their activity levels."

Sol.3.(b) It shows the environment can change inherited traits.

The passage mentions "epigenetic tags can be inherited across generations" and this "challenges long-held notions of fixed genetic destiny," meaning the environment can influence what we inherit.

Sol.4.(c) A flexible genetic plan that life experiences can change.

The passage says inheritance is not as a rigid blueprint, but as a malleable score being continuously re-orchestrated by life itself, meaning it's flexible and changed by life.

Sol.5.(c) That genes are always stronger than environment.

The passage talks about a "dynamic interplay between nature and nurture" where nurture can influence nature, which goes against the idea that genes are always dominant. The other options are mentioned as benefits.

SET - 2

Sol.6.(b) The challenges and consequences of the digital divide.

The passage focuses on defining the digital divide, explaining its various aspects, its profound consequences, and the interventions needed to bridge it.

Sol.7.(b) The difference in access to modern technology and related skills.

The passage states that the digital divide refers to the chasm separating those with access to modern information and communication technology from those without, and it also includes disparities in skills needed to navigate the digital landscape.

Sol.8.(b) Broadband quality and digital skills.

The passage explains that the divide encompasses disparities in broadband connectivity, affordability, quality of service, and the skills needed to effectively navigate the digital landscape, in addition to hardware access.

Sol.9.(c) Reduced educational opportunities.

The passage states that those on the wrong side of the divide face reduced educational opportunities.

Sol.10.(b) Governments expanding infrastructure.

The passage suggests that bridging the gap requires multi-faceted interventions, including government initiatives to expand infrastructure.

SET - 3

Sol.11.(b) To facilitate plant reproduction.

(Line/s from the passage - Pollinators, primarily insects like bees, butterflies, and moths, but also birds and bats, play a crucial role in the reproduction of over 80% of the world's flowering plants, including many food crops essential for human sustenance.)

Sol.12.(b) Specific shapes, colors, or scents

(Line/s from the passage - For instance, some flowers have evolved specific shapes, colors, or scents to attract particular pollinators, while pollinators have developed specialized mouthparts or behaviors to access the rewards offered by these flowers.)

Sol.13.(c) Increased rainfall

(Line/s from the passage - Habitat loss due to urbanization and agriculture, pesticide use (especially neonicotinoids), climate change altering bloom times, and the spread of diseases and invasive species are collectively contributing to a dramatic decline in pollinator populations worldwide.)

Sol.14.(b)**Lower crop yields and higher food costs**

(Line/s from the passage - Many fruits, vegetables, and nuts rely heavily on animal pollination, and a reduction in pollinator services can lead to lower yields, reduced quality, and increased food costs.)

Sol.15.(c) Promoting pollinator-friendly farming practices

(Line/s from the passage - Scientists are actively researching solutions, from promoting pollinator-friendly farming practices and creating urban pollinator gardens to developing less harmful pest management strategies and conserving natural habitats.)

SET - 4

Sol.16.(c)

Liam's unexplained withdrawal and behavioral changes.

The main reason for the tension is Liam's sudden withdrawal, his late nights, and the abrupt change in his friend group, which his mother observes and wishes to discuss.

Sol.17.(c) The fear of exclusion and desire to fit in.

Liam initially participated in activities he was uncomfortable with due to a desperate desire to fit in and a suffocating fear of being truly alone or ostracized from his social circle.

Sol.18.(c) His old friends feel distant, almost alien now.

Liam's old friends, with whom he once shared genuine laughter, now feel distant and almost alien to him.

Sol.19.(b) A powerful knot of shame and fear.

A powerful knot of shame and fear acts as an emotional barrier, preventing Liam from opening up to his mother despite her genuine concern.

Sol.20.(c) To explore the internal and external pressures teenagers face in social dynamics.

The author's primary purpose is to explore the internal and external pressures teenagers encounter in social dynamics, particularly focusing on the conflict between authentic self and online image, and the fear of social exclusion.

SET - 5

Sol.21.(b) It fails to provide immediate job readiness and specialized skills for the modern workforce.

The passage indicates that critics contend liberal arts degrees are impractical because they do not prepare graduates with the specific skills needed for the contemporary job market.

Sol.22.(c) It teaches students 'how to think'.

Proponents of a liberal arts education emphasize that its core function is to instruct students on the process of critical thought rather than dictating specific content.

Sol.23.(d) Specialized vocational training

While a liberal arts education develops analytical reasoning, communication, and problem-solving, it does not primarily focus on specialized vocational training.

Sol.24.(b) They become more valuable.

The passage suggests that in an age of automation and AI, the human attributes cultivated by a liberal arts education, such as creativity and ethical reasoning, gain increased importance.

Sol.25.(c) Individuals who can adapt to new challenges and collaborate effectively.

The passage highlights that modern employers are seeking individuals who possess the flexibility to adjust to new situations and work well with others.

SET - 6

Sol.26.(b) It reduces deep engagement and comprehension.

The passage mentions that reading on screens often leads to superficial engagement as readers tend to skim rather than read deeply. This clearly indicates that digital reading reduces deep comprehension.

Sol.27.(c) It provides portability and convenience.

The passage states that digital reading allows users to carry thousands of books in one device and provides built-in tools for easy reference, making it highly portable and convenient.

Sol.28.(b) Deeply engaging.

The word "immersive" in the given sentence means something that fully engages the reader's attention and senses, creating a deep and focused experience.

Sol.29.(c) By reducing paper consumption.

The passage clearly notes that digital platforms promote environmental sustainability by reducing paper consumption, making reading more eco-friendly.

Sol.30.(c) Using both digital and print reading mindfully.

The author concludes that readers should strike a balance between print and digital reading. Mindful use of both forms ensures convenience without losing depth and focus.

SET - 7

Sol.31.(b) 1969

(Line/s from the passage- The formation of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) in 1969 marked a turning point, reflecting India's ambition to harness space technology for national development.)

Sol.32.(c) Chandrayaan-3

(Line / s from the passage - With the successful launch of the

Chandrayaan-3 mission in 2023, India became the first nation to land on the Moon's south pole.)

Sol.33.(b) Conduct India's first human spaceflight

(Line/s from the passage- Meanwhile, projects like Gaganyaan, India's first human spaceflight program, signify the country's leap toward manned missions.)

Sol.34.(c) Lack of public interest

(Line/s from the passage - Yet, challenges persist – limited budgets, brain drain, and the need for continuous technological upgrades.)

Sol.35.(b) To combine affordability, innovation, and collaboration

(Line/s from the passage- Still, India's space vision remains clear: to combine affordability, innovation, and global collaboration to reach new cosmic milestones.)

SET - 8

Sol.36.(b) Technology has both enhanced and challenged human cognition

The passage highlights both the advantages (efficiency, problem-solving) and disadvantages (attention loss, digital amnesia) of technology, emphasizing the need for balance. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.37.(b) Technology causes people to forget essential information

(Line/s from the passage - "Psychologists argue that reliance on external devices for information storage... may erode our natural cognitive abilities.")

Sol.38.(b) They argue it allows the mind to focus on complex thinking

(Line/s from the passage - "They claim that such delegation allows the human mind to focus on higher-order thinking rather than routine recall.")

Sol.39.(b) Balanced and reflective

The author acknowledges both the advantages and drawbacks of technology, emphasizing mindfulness and balance. Hence, "Balanced and reflective" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.40.(b) How to balance cognitive independence with technological reliance

The passage focuses on the need to use technology wisely, maintaining human cognitive strength while embracing digital tools. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 9

Sol.41.(b) To reduce carbon emissions.

The passage highlights that renewable energy helps lower carbon emissions and fight climate change.

Sol.42.(c) High initial setup costs and inconsistent production.

It states that the main drawbacks are high installation costs and dependence on weather conditions.

Sol.43.(b) They provide financial and policy support to encourage its use.

Governments promote renewable energy through subsidies, tax benefits, and research funding.

Sol.44.(c) It will balance renewable and traditional sources.

The passage notes that the future lies in combining renewable energy with improved technology and storage systems.

Sol.45.(b) Ongoing progress and drive.

The word 'momentum' implies the continuing force or drive that keeps progress moving forward.

SET - 10

Sol.46.(b) An essential component of understanding and awareness

In the given passage, the author suggests that silence is a powerful presence that encourages reflection, clarity, and awareness rather than mere emptiness or withdrawal. Hence, option b is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.47.(c) Fragmentizes experience and diminishes reflection

(Line/s from the passage- Philosophers from Lao Tzu to Wittgenstein have observed that language, though powerful, often fractures experience into fragments that silence alone can reconcile.)

Sol.48.(a) Silence both conceals and reveals truth.

In the given passage, the author notes that silence can either obscure or clarify depending on context, showing its dual nature. Hence, option a is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.49.(a) Reflective and philosophical

In the given passage, the author explores the meaning, value, and paradox of silence through deep contemplation and references to philosophers like Lao Tzu and Wittgenstein. Hence, "Reflective and philosophical" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.50.(a) A deviation from the norm

In the given passage, the author refers to silence as something rare or unusual in modern society. Hence, option a is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 11

Sol.51.(b) Modern research is influenced by social and political forces.

However, this notion of neutrality is increasingly untenable in a world where data, algorithms, and biotechnologies directly shape social realities.

Sol.52.(b) Ethical reflection is essential for genuine progress.

The given passage states that "ethical deliberation is not an impediment to progress but its precondition." This means real progress cannot happen without moral consideration. Hence, option b is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.53.(a) Technical ability versus moral responsibility.

In the given passage, "capability" refers to the expanding power of science, what humans can do through innovation while "conscience" represents the ethical judgment guiding what should be done. The phrase highlights the tension between scientific advancement and moral accountability. Hence, option a is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.54.(b) Analytical and cautionary.

In the given passage, the author examines science in a balanced and thoughtful manner acknowledging its achievements while warning about its ethical risks. Hence, option b is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.55.(b) Judgment

In the given passage, the word "Discernment" refers to the ability to judge wisely between what should and should not be pursued in science. Hence, "Judgment" is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 12**Sol.56.(b) Adaptability.**

(Line/s from the passage- adaptability is not merely an option but a critical necessity for survival and growth.)

Sol.57.(d) Geopolitical events.

The passage lists geopolitical events as an external factor, alongside technological advancements and consumer preferences. Labour market and financial market instability are categorised as internal challenges.

Sol.58.(b) They offer opportunities but can make existing products obsolete.

(Line/s from the passage- technological advancements, while offering immense opportunities, also present a double-edged sword. Rapid innovation can render existing products or services obsolete.)

Sol.59.(c) Labour market fluctuations.

The passage mentions labour market fluctuations, including shortages of skilled workers or rising wage demands, as an internal challenge. The other options are external factors.

Sol.60.(c) Building resilience through risk management and agility.

Businesses are mandated to shift towards building resilience, which involves investing in robust risk management frameworks, diversifying supply bases, and fostering continuous learning and innovation to navigate pervasive volatility effectively.

SET - 13**Sol.61.(c) Digital systems subtly influence human perception and autonomy.**

The central idea of the given passage discusses how algorithms and digital systems shape human choices, behavior, and perception while creating an illusion of autonomy. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.62.(b) online options appear diverse but are algorithmically curated.

In the given passage phrase "illusion of choice" refers to how the internet gives users the appearance of having many options, while in reality, algorithms control and filter what they see. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.63.(c) It mirrors existing human flaws.

The author mentions that artificial intelligence inherits the biases of its creators and the data it consumes, indicating that AI reflects and reproduces human prejudice and imperfection. Rather than solving ethical problems, it often mirrors the same flaws found in human judgment. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.64.(a) Technology isolates and empowers simultaneously.

The given passage describes a paradox of empowerment: humanity today has unprecedented access to knowledge and connectivity, yet is more vulnerable to manipulation than ever before. This captures the dual nature of technology, it empowers people with information while simultaneously reducing their autonomy and exposing them to control. Hence, option (a) is the

most appropriate answer.

Sol.65.(a) Alarmist yet hopeful

In the given passage, the author adopts an alarmist yet hopeful tone by warning about the growing influence of algorithms, the manipulation of human perception, and the ethical challenges of artificial intelligence, while still expressing optimism that technology can be rehumanized to serve human values. Hence, "Alarmist yet hopeful" is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 14**Sol.66.(b)** Access to quality education, healthcare, and digital literacy.

The given passage states that inequality extends beyond mere income gaps to encompass unequal access to quality education, healthcare, and digital literacy.

Sol.67.(b) Systemic discrimination, violence, and a significant wage gap.

The passage notes, "Women... frequently confront systemic discrimination, gender-based violence, and a significant wage gap."

Sol.68.(b) Communicable and non - communicable diseases.

(Line/s from the passage- India battles a dual burden of communicable and non-communicable diseases.)

Sol.69.(b) It disproportionately affects the poorest segments and agricultural communities.

The passage explains that environmental degradation disproportionately affects agricultural communities and those reliant on natural resources and the poorest segments of society.

Sol.70.(b) The well-being, equity, and dignity.

The passage concludes by demanding a commitment to fostering a society where progress is measured not just by economic indicators, but by the well-being, equity, and dignity afforded to every single individual.

SET - 15**Sol.71.(b) Analytical**

In an analytical tone, the author looks at all the facts and reasons about a topic and explains them in a clear and organized way. The given passage examines both originality and imitation through reasoned comparison and balanced argumentation. Hence, "Analytical" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.72.(b) A foundational process for achieving mastery

(Line/s from the passage- To imitate with discernment is to study the anatomy of excellence; it is the apprenticeship through which mastery often gestates.)

Sol.73.(a) Society's excessive glorification of originality at the expense of learning from the past

The phrase "fetishization of originality" implies that society has developed an obsession or over-glorification of originality, treating it as something sacred or superior. The author criticizes this attitude because it causes creators to ignore the importance of imitation and learning from past knowledge. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.74.(a) Every creative idea carries traces of the ideas that

came before it.

The phrase means that creativity is never entirely new; it's influenced and shaped by earlier thoughts, ideas, and works, much like an echo that changes slightly as it travels through time. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.75.(c) The old and the new are synthesized into meaningful innovation

The given passage concludes that creativity is "an act of intelligent remembrance," blending originality with imitation to produce lasting innovation. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 16

Sol.76.(b) Symbolic reasoning and expert systems

(Line/s from the passage - early AI research, emerging in the mid-20th century, focused on symbolic reasoning and expert systems.)

Sol.77.(c) Machine learning, especially deep learning

(Line/s from the passage - however, the true inflection point arrived with advancements in machine learning, particularly deep learning, which leverages neural networks inspired by the human brain.)

Sol.78.(b) The difficulty in understanding how complex AI models make decisions

(Line/s from the passage - the 'black box' problem, where the decision-making processes of complex AI models are opaque, further complicates accountability.)

Sol.79.(c) Environmental impact

(Line/s from the passage - concerns about job displacement, algorithmic bias, privacy invasion, and the potential for autonomous weapons systems loom large.)

Sol.80.(c) A collaborative, interdisciplinary approach to development and policy

(Line/s from the passage - a collaborative, interdisciplinary approach involving policymakers, technologists, ethicists, and the public will be crucial in steering AI towards a benevolent future.)

SET - 17

Sol.81.(b) Unsustainable and unequal urban growth

The passage highlights how India's urbanisation is unbalanced, environmentally harmful, and prioritises visibility over sustainability. Hence, the issue discussed is unsustainable and unequal urban growth.

Sol.82.(c) Ignoring core issues like waste and housing

The passage states that the smart city concept is superficial because it overlooks fundamental problems such as waste management, water scarcity, and housing.

Sol.83.(a) Overcrowded big cities and declining small towns

Unequal distribution of resources leads to overcrowded metropolitan areas and neglected smaller towns, creating a regional imbalance.

Sol.84.(c) Human-centred inclusivity

The author emphasises that cities should be designed around people and inclusivity, not vehicles or exclusivity, indicating a human-focused approach.

Sol.85.(d) Shifting focus from appearance to genuine outcomes

The passage stresses that current urban policies emphasise optics rather than sustainable results. The author advocates moving from superficial displays of progress to policies that deliver real, measurable outcomes.

SET - 18

Sol.86.(c) Supporting British economic interests

(Line/s from the passage- The colonial economy thus functioned as an appendage to British industry—structured to benefit the metropolis while impoverishing the colony.)

Sol.87.(b) They aimed to enhance colonial control and extraction

(Line/s from the passage- The railways, often celebrated as symbols of modernization, primarily served the colonial purpose of resource extraction and troop movement rather than national integration.)

Sol.88.(b) The collapse of indigenous industries.

The given passage mentions that the decline of local industries displaced artisans and created widespread unemployment. This describes deindustrialization, meaning the breakdown or destruction of India's traditional handicraft and textile industries due to colonial economic policies and the influx of British manufactured goods. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.89.(c) They operated within a biased system favoring British capital

(Line/s from the passage- Even the emergence of Indian entrepreneurs in the late nineteenth century occurred within a highly restrictive framework that favored British capital.

Sol.90.(b) Enduring structural economic inequalities

(Line/s from the passage- This economic pattern laid the foundation for structural inequalities that persisted long after independence.)

SET - 19

Sol.91.(b) It requires a comprehensive, data-driven, and collaborative approach

The author emphasises that air pollution cannot be solved through isolated or temporary actions. It needs integrated policies, scientific monitoring, and joint efforts from governments and citizens, indicating a comprehensive and collaborative approach.

Sol.92.(b) Lack of accurate and continuous monitoring systems

The passage highlights that many cities lack reliable, real-time air quality data, which hinders enforcement and planning. Thus, inadequate monitoring is identified as a key weakness in pollution management.

Sol.93.(c) Through electric mobility, efficient public transport, and vehicle phase-outs

The author suggests long-term transport reforms like promoting electric vehicles, expanding public transport, and removing old polluting vehicles to curb emissions effectively.

Sol.94.(b) It can drive meaningful change through behavioural adjustments

The passage notes that citizens' actions—like reducing waste burning and conserving energy—directly affect air quality, making public participation vital for real progress.



Sol.95.(c) Coordinated regional policies and community engagement are crucial

The passage calls for integrated, cross-border cooperation (shared airsheds, joint inventories, early warning systems) alongside civic participation, indicating that coordinated regional action with community engagement is essential for lasting air-quality gains.

SET - 20

Sol.96.(b) Truth in the digital age is shaped by algorithms and personal biases

The central argument of the given passage highlights that digital platforms

and personal biases now influence how truth is perceived, replacing objective and verifiable understanding. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.97.(b) The emotional and viral nature of online engagement

The given passage states that "Social media platforms... amplify voices not by credibility but by engagement metrics. As a result, emotional intensity often outweighs evidence, and virality substitutes for validity." This clearly shows that misinformation spreads because emotional and viral content gets more engagement, not because of a lack of regulation or journalists. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.98.(c) It causes individuals to seek information that supports their beliefs

(Line/s from the passage - The modern individual, inundated by competing narratives, gravitates toward information that aligns with pre-existing beliefs—a psychological phenomenon known as confirmation bias.)

Sol.99.(c) Critically analyzing information and opposing views

(Line/ from the passage - True digital literacy, therefore, lies not in constant connectivity but in critical awareness — questioning sources, examining intent, and embracing discomfort in confronting opposing viewpoints.)

Sol.100.(a) Critical and analytical

The author critically examines how digital platforms distort truth and analytically explains the causes such as algorithms, biases, and lack of critical awareness while urging readers to think responsibly. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 21

Sol.101.(b) It examines how technological and social changes have commodified time and altered human experience.

The passage discusses how technological and social evolution has transformed time from a natural rhythm into a measurable and monetized commodity, affecting human experience and perception.

Sol.102.(b) The more people try to optimize time, the more they feel deprived of it.

The author suggests that the modern obsession with saving time only leads to greater pressure and dissatisfaction, as the pursuit of efficiency prevents people from truly experiencing or enjoying time.

Sol.103.(b) They perceived time as cyclical and harmonious with nature rather than mechanical and fragmented.

Pre-industrial societies viewed time as cyclical and

interconnected with nature and community, unlike the linear, mechanical perception of time in the modern digital age.

Sol.104.(c) It creates impatience, anxiety, and a constant sense of urgency.

The passage explains that instant connectivity and constant communication create impatience and anxiety, replacing reflection and calmness with a sense of perpetual urgency.

Sol.105.(c) Reimagining time as a space for presence, reflection, and meaning rather than as a commodity.

The author proposes that individuals should redefine time not as a commodity to be consumed but as a meaningful experience to be inhabited with presence, reflection, and balance.

SET - 22

Sol.106.(a) Justice is about fairness, while equality ensures sameness in treatment.

(Line/s from the passage - Justice concerns itself with fairness — ensuring that individuals receive what they are due, based on merit, need, or equity. Equality, on the other hand, demands that all individuals be treated the same, without discrimination or privilege.)

Sol.107.(b) To highlight historical and modern perspectives on justice.

The author refers to Aristotle and Rawls to illustrate how thinkers from different eras have examined the concept of justice. Aristotle focused on proportional fairness, while Rawls introduced the idea of fairness through the "veil of ignorance," showing the evolution of thought on justice across time. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.108.(b) It simplifies complex ideas into rigid procedures.

(Line/s from the passage - Bureaucratic systems often reduce nuanced principles into rigid procedures, where equality is measured by uniform rules rather than outcomes.)

Sol.109.(c) They can perpetuate hidden biases under the guise of neutrality.

The given passage explains that algorithms in areas like hiring or law enforcement "claim objectivity but often reproduce existing biases encoded in data." This means that although they appear neutral, they can actually continue or even worsen discrimination, making processes seem fair while producing unjust outcomes. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.110.(a) Societies must pursue fairness that adapts to context rather than mechanical equality.

The given passage highlights that equality means treating everyone the same, but true justice requires fairness that takes into account different circumstances and disadvantages. It suggests that societies should aim for equity, which balances fairness and equality through empathy and adaptability instead of following rigid, uniform rules. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 23

Sol.111.(c) Exhausting - making one very tired and drained of energy.

Restorative - having the ability to make one feel strong or healthy again.

Energizing - giving energy or vitality.

Refreshing - making one feel reinvigorated or lively.

Healing - making well or restoring health.

Sol.112.(c) By helping individuals process experiences calmly and clearly.

Solitude helps people process experiences and maintain emotional balance.

Sol.113.(b) They tend to develop stronger empathy and self-awareness.

The passage notes that people who spend time alone often show greater empathy and self-awareness.

Sol.114.(d) Equates success mainly with productivity and visible activity.

The passage highlights that society measures worth by busyness and productivity, overlooking the value of stillness.

Sol.115.(b) Overreliance on digital communication and constant stimulation.

The passage states that digital interaction and constant stimulation have reduced people's ability to spend time alone.

SET - 24

Sol.116.(b) Economic growth versus environmental sustainability

(Line/s from the passage- India faces the dual challenge of maintaining growth while mitigating environmental degradation.)

Sol.117.(b) Weak implementation of green policies

The given passage states that "Government policies often highlight the rhetoric of green development, yet implementation remains inconsistent." This clearly indicates that despite having environmental policies, poor or weak implementation is a key reason for continuing environmental degradation. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.118.(c) Climate variability impacting agriculture

(Line/s from the passage- Agricultural dependency makes them highly vulnerable to climate variability—erratic monsoons, declining groundwater levels, and soil infertility directly threaten livelihoods.)

Sol.119.(d) It advances development but worsens ecological imbalance

(Line/s from the passage- The irony lies in the fact that while technological progress promises efficiency, it simultaneously accelerates ecological imbalance when pursued without ethical and environmental accountability.)

Sol.120.(b) A shift toward ecological awareness and responsible mindset

(Line/s from the passage - True sustainability, the author argues, requires a paradigm shift—from reactive regulation to proactive ecological consciousness.)

SET - 25

Sol.121.(b) It helps predict and influence human behavior

(Line/s from the passage- Tech giants employ sophisticated algorithms to track user preferences, predict behavior, and deliver personalized advertisements that seem almost intuitive.)

Sol.122.(c) Invasion of individual privacy

(Line/s from the passage- While this data-driven world enhances

convenience and efficiency, it simultaneously exposes individuals to unprecedented privacy risks.)

Sol.123.(b) Who truly owns personal data and controls its use?

(Line/s from the passage- This imbalance of power raises critical ethical questions: Who truly owns personal data? How much control should individuals retain over their digital footprints?)

Sol.124.(b) They safeguard user privacy through consent and transparency

(Line/s from the passage- Stronger data protection laws, such as the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), aim to empower users by ensuring transparency and consent.)

Sol.125.(b) Digital literacy and ethical corporate conduct

(Line/s from the passage- However, legislation alone cannot solve the problem. Public awareness, ethical corporate behavior, and the promotion of digital literacy are equally vital.)

SET - 26

Sol.126.(b) They supply mineral-rich fluids that support chemosynthetic life

Hydrothermal vents release mineral-laden fluids that sustain bacteria using chemical reactions to produce energy, forming the foundation of the deep-sea food chain.

Sol.127.(a) Life cannot exist without sunlight

The discovery of vent ecosystems showed that organisms can survive using chemical energy instead of sunlight, challenging the earlier belief that sunlight was essential for all life.

Sol.128.(b) It threatens to destroy delicate and ancient ecosystems

The passage warns that mining for minerals like cobalt and nickel may irreversibly harm fragile habitats that evolved over thousands of years.

Sol.129.(c) Producing food through chemical reactions

Chemosynthetic refers to organisms that synthesise food using energy derived from chemical processes rather than sunlight, as occurs near hydrothermal vents.

Sol.130.(c) The abyssal plain hosts unique ecosystems that rely on chemical energy and need protection

The passage emphasises that life in the abyssal plain depends on chemical energy from hydrothermal vents and warns against the damage caused by deep-sea mining, highlighting both uniqueness and the need for preservation.

SET - 27

Sol.131.(b) Analytical yet reverent

The author maintains an analytical tone when discussing the evolution of polar exploration while expressing respect for the explorers' courage and the spirit of discovery.

Sol.132.(a) The frozen parts of Earth's surface such as glaciers and polar ice caps

The term "cryosphere" refers to all frozen water components of the Earth system—snow, glaciers, permafrost, and ice caps—which are key indicators of climate change.

Sol.133.(d) It acts as a complement explaining the kind of study.

The phrase "in courage, endurance, and discovery" functions as a prepositional complement that specifies what the "study" is about, describing its nature rather than modifying "journey."

Sol.134.(b) From exploration for conquest to exploration for environmental understanding

The passage contrasts early explorers motivated by glory and national pride with modern missions focused on climate research and ecological preservation.

Sol.135.(b) Careful management and responsibility

The word "stewardship" conveys the idea of responsible care and protection, implying that modern exploration involves safeguarding the environment rather than exploiting it.

SET - 28

Sol.136.(b) Carbohydrates, proteins, and fats.

(Line/s from the passage - Macronutrients – carbohydrates, proteins, and fats – are required in larger quantities as they provide the bulk of energy and building blocks for bodily structures.)

Sol.137.(c) They play pivotal roles in enzymatic reactions, immune function, and cellular health.

(Line/s from the passage - Micronutrients, though needed in smaller amounts, are equally indispensable. These include vitamins and minerals, which play pivotal roles in myriad enzymatic reactions, immune function, and overall cellular health.)

Sol.138.(c) Frequent deviation from a balanced diet with processed foods and excessive sugar.

(Line/s from the passage - However, modern dietary patterns, often characterized by highly processed foods, excessive sugar, and unhealthy fats, frequently deviate from this ideal.)

Sol.139.(d) Body's primary energy source.

It is mentioned in the passage that carbohydrates are the body's primary energy source.

Sol.140.(c) Specific health issues, from mild impairments to severe diseases.

(Line/s from the passage- A deficiency in any micronutrient can lead to specific health issues, ranging from mild impairments to severe diseases.)

SET - 29

Sol.141.(c) Mars colonization is becoming realistic

In the given passage, the author implies that the phrase "increasingly viewed as a tangible objective" means that what was once considered a mere idea or confined to science fiction is now becoming realistic and achievable because of rapid technological advancements and growing commercial initiatives. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.142.(b) Converting into water, oxygen, and fuel

(Line/s from the passage - which includes converting subsurface water ice into potable water, breathable oxygen, and fuel for return journeys.)

Sol.143.(d) Martian flora and fauna

(Line/s from the passage - Yet, the Martian environment remains harsh and inhospitable: extreme temperature fluctuations, low atmospheric pressure, high radiation levels, and the psychological strain of isolation pose

significant obstacles.)

Sol.144.(b) SpaceX

(Line/s from the passage - Programs led by NASA, in tandem with private enterprises like SpaceX, aim to send humans to the Red Planet within the next few decades)

Sol.145.(a) To highlight commercial and ownership concerns

The given passage mentions that the legal framework for extraterrestrial property is ambiguous, highlighting concerns about private and commercial ownership as corporations invest in Martian ventures. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 30

Sol.146.(b) The flexibility of language allows it to survive and stay relevant.

The passage highlights that language continues to thrive because of its flexibility and ability to stay relevant in changing times.

Sol.147.(c) It has blended written and spoken forms through new symbols and abbreviations.

The passage explains that digital communication has blended written and spoken forms by introducing symbols and abbreviations.

Sol.148.(b) Language evolves because humans are capable of innovation and flexibility.

The author connects the evolution of language with human innovation and flexibility, showing that both adjust to new realities.

Sol.149.(a) Maintaining traditional forms and avoiding modern variations.

The term linguistic purity signifies maintaining traditional forms and avoiding modern variations, which purists prefer to preserve language standards.

Sol.150.(b) Appreciative

The author expresses an appreciative view of linguistic change, seeing it as a sign of vitality and renewal rather than decline.

SET - 31

Sol.151.(b) Self-examination

The word introspection in the passage refers to looking inward and assessing one's own thoughts, feelings, and motives. Self-examination accurately conveys this meaning

Sol.152.(b) They gradually rewire mental patterns and habits.

The passage explains that repetition strengthens neural pathways, turning deliberate effort into natural behaviour. Hence, consistent small actions are more effective because they reshape mental habits over time.

Sol.153.(c) Gentle self-compassion and patience.

The author states that improvement driven by self-criticism causes anxiety, whereas kindness and patience foster resilience. Therefore, the recommended approach to flaws is self-compassion.

Sol.154.(b) As a circular process of learning and adjustment.

The passage describes self-improvement as a cyclical process requiring reflection and recalibration rather than a straight path.

Sol.155.(b) Improvement is about authenticity and alignment with one's values.

The final line emphasises that real self-improvement involves living in closer harmony with one's deeper values, not becoming someone else. Hence, authenticity and alignment is the central idea.

SET - 32

Sol.156.(c) It challenges anthropocentric assumptions and fosters ecological empathy.

The given passage states that environmental stewardship "interrogates anthropocentric paradigms, challenging the assumption that human needs automatically supersede ecological thresholds." It also highlights the importance of "ecological empathy" and recognizing the intrinsic value of nonhuman life. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.157.(b) Superficial acts that obscure deeper environmental problems.

The given passage mentions "token gestures such as symbolic tree-planting campaigns or eco-certifications without systemic reform," describing them as performative. These actions create an appearance of environmental commitment but fail to address underlying issues. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.158.(c) By promoting innovation and adaptive problem-solving through diverse engagement.

The given passage states that environmental stewardship drives "innovation in renewable energy, sustainable agriculture, and circular economies" and highlights that "diverse stakeholder engagement... enhances adaptive capacity and problem-solving." Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.159.(b) Human well - being is inseparable from ecological health.

In the given passage, the phrase "intertwined fate with the natural world" suggests a deep connection between humans and the environment. It indicates that human survival, health, and future depend directly on the state of the ecological system. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.160.(b) Maintained resilience by aligning human activity with ecological balance.

The given passage states that historical societies "harmonized their activities with natural rhythms—through agrarian practices, sacred groves, or community-managed water systems and exemplified resilience and sustainability." This shows that their resilience came from maintaining ecological balance. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 33

Sol.161.(b) Present participial phrase functioning as an adverb

The phrase "providing a direct channel between the creator and the audience" begins with the present participle "providing" and modifies the main clause "The medium allows exceptional independence" by explaining how or in what way the medium allows independence. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.162.(b) Adverbial phrase modifying "must negotiate"

The phrase "Beyond the casual image of informal chats" describes under what circumstances or in addition to what

context the podcasters must negotiate the ecosystem. It modifies the verb "must negotiate," making it function as an adverbial phrase. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.163.(b) Complex and detailed

In the given passage, "intricate" describes the ecosystem of audio production quality, listener analytics, content licensing, sponsorship deals, and social media amplification. This indicates that podcasters must manage a complex and detailed system. Hence, "Complex and detailed" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.164.(a) Exclusive

In the given passage, "egalitarian" refers to the idea that podcasting offers an equal opportunity platform where anyone can, in principle, reach a global audience. The antonym of this is "exclusive," meaning restricted to a select few. Hence, "Exclusive" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.165.(a) The tension between casual perception of podcasting and the professional demands of the field

The given passage emphasizes that podcasting is often seen as a casual hobby, but in reality, it requires professional skills, such as audio production, marketing, audience engagement, and financial management. This contrast between perception and reality forms the central tension of the passage. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 34

Sol.166.(b) Gradual build-up of fluid

The term 'accumulation' implies lymphoedema, which is described as abnormal fluid build-up. The passage highlights persistent swelling caused by excess lymph collecting in tissues, so "gradual build-up of fluid" reflects the intended meaning. Hence, "gradual build-up of fluid" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.167.(b) Increased likelihood of being affected

The term 'susceptibility' in the passage means a greater chance of being affected by infections.

Sol.168.(c) invaders

In the given sentence, there is an adjective before the blank. This means we need a noun whose meaning describes the adjective. 'Invaders' is a noun. Hence, 'invaders' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.169.(c) Drinking enough water and staying active

The passage states that regular physical activity and proper hydration support the lymphatic system. These actions help maintain natural fluid movement and overall function.

Sol.170.(a) which

In the given sentence, we need a relative pronoun for the noun 'pump', which is a non-living thing. 'Which' is used for non-living things. Hence, 'which' is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 35

Sol.171.(b) Simple Past Active

The action "demonstrated" refers to a completed event in the past performed by the Wright brothers, making it a simple past tense in active voice. Hence, "Simple Past Active" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.172.(a) Adjective phrase modifying "supersonic transport"

The phrase "epitomized by Concorde in 1976" functions as an adjective, providing additional detail about the noun "supersonic transport." Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.173.(b) Introducing

In the given passage, the word "ushering" is used to indicate that the Wright brothers' flight introduced or began the era of modern aviation. Hence, "Introducing" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.174.(c) Highly significant and altering

The word "transformative" is used to describe aviation's effect as bringing about profound and significant changes in human mobility. Hence, "Highly significant and altering" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.175.(b) Analytical and celebratory

The given passage combines analysis of aviation's evolution with celebration of its transformative impact on society and technology. Hence, "Analytical and celebratory" is the most appropriate answer.

SSC Selection Post (Phase - XIII)

SET - 36 [Q .176. to Q .179.]

In the modern era, protecting the environment is a global priority. Pollution affects air quality, water sources, and the health of all living beings. A mixture of simple actions, such as recycling plastic or planting trees, and reducing waste can help keep the planet safe.

Apart from individual efforts, using renewable energy plays a significant role in conservation. Utilizing solar power, wind energy, and eco-friendly products provides long-term benefits for the earth. Conversely, burning excessive fossil fuels can result in severe problems like global warming and climate change.

Conservation is not merely about saving nature; it also ensures human survival. Green spaces provide oxygen, which helps purify the air and sustain life. Even small steps like saving water or electricity can generate a huge impact. Saving the earth requires collective responsibility, but the rewards are invaluable.

Matriculation Level 29/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.176. Choose the correct article to complete the sentence:

"Adopting _____ sustainable lifestyle is necessary for the future."

- (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) No Article

Q.177. Identify the sentence with correct subject-verb agreement:

- (a) Pollution from cars harm the atmosphere.
(b) The result of these actions represent a danger.
(c) Renewable energy and recycling are vital for nature.
(d) Burning fossil fuels cause global warming.

Q.178. What provides oxygen according to the passage?

- (a) Burning fossil fuels (b) Green spaces
(c) Industrial factories (d) Plastic waste

Q.179. Find the synonym of "significant" from the passage.

- (a) Important (b) Useless (c) Tiny (d) Rare

SET - 37 [Q .180. to Q .184.]

Memory, researchers argue, exists because the mind is constantly seeking to predict the future. Without past experiences, the brain would struggle to anticipate dangers or rewards, because memories allow our systems to navigate the unknown. This predictive instinct is a vital asset. A prepared mind reacts faster, which leads to better decisions, which

ensures safety, and therefore makes survival more probable.

But retaining information is only a fraction of the story. Memories also possess a profound influence on our identity because once they are encoded, they shape personality. Even more significantly, memories can be strengthened, altered, or faded—but only if we comprehend how they persist.

At the heart of every memory is a biological sequence that comprises three stages: encoding, storage, and retrieval. This sequence is the basis of all cognitive retention. Encoding is the input that transforms perception into a construct, storage is the maintenance of that information, and retrieval is what enables your mind to access the data later.

Grasping this sequence is the first step in mastering memory, whether you aim to learn a new skill or recall a lost name.

Graduate Level 24/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.180. Identify the correct passive voice form of the following sentence:

"Memories also possess a profound influence on our identity."

- (a) Our identity is profoundly influenced by memories.
(b) A profound influence is also possessed on our identity by memories.
(c) Our identity has been influenced profoundly by memories.
(d) Memories influence our identity profoundly.

Q.181. Choose the correct indirect speech conversion of the sentence.

"Researchers argue, 'Memory exists because the mind is constantly seeking to predict the future'."

- (a) Researchers argue that memory exists because the mind is constantly seeking to predict the future.
(b) Researchers argued that memory existed because the mind was constantly seeking to predict the future.
(c) Researchers argue memory had existed because the mind constantly sought to predict the future.
(d) Researchers have argued that memory exists as the mind constantly looks to predict the future.

Q.182. What is the meaning of the word "navigate" in the sentence:

"because memories allow our systems to navigate the unknown."

- (a) To ignore completely (b) To move through or manage a path
(c) To remain still (d) To forget quickly

Q.183. Choose the best synonym for the word "sequence" in the sentence:

"At the heart of every memory is a biological sequence that comprises three stages."

- (a) Disorder (b) Series (c) Chaos (d) Ending

Q.184. According to the passage, why is the predictive instinct of memory considered an asset?

- (a) Because it helps the mind react faster, ensuring safety and survival.
(b) Because it allows the brain to store unlimited amounts of data.
(c) Because it prevents the brain from changing old memories.
(d) Because it eliminates the need for learning new skills.

SET - 38 [Q .185. to Q .189.]

"The essence of human existence lies not in a predetermined nature, but in the radical freedom of its unfolding. The individual, in their search for meaning, initially believes that their identity is something fixed and inherited. However, through the anxiety of choice, they realize that this identity is not truly given but is

constructed by the will itself. The perceived conflict between facticity and transcendence is thus synthesized in the project, revealing that being is not the static possession of a soul but a dynamic process in which the subject designs and assumes their own essence.

This realization emerges through a sequence of crises, in which every moment of life, pretending to offer stability, exposes its own contingency. The concept of bad faith illustrates this: the conscious subject seeks comfort in roles, yet in clinging to a defined label, they ironically escape their own responsibility. The conformist, by reducing themselves to a mere object, denies themselves a fully authentic existence. Conversely, the anxious individual, through doubt and self-reflection, achieves a sharper sense of agency, proving that meaning is not discovered but created through action and choice.

Graduate Level 25/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.185. Which of the following best identifies the grammatical role of the phrase "in their search for meaning" in the sentence:

"The individual, in their search for meaning, initially believes that their identity is something fixed and inherited."

- (a) Adjective modifying "individual"
- (b) Adverbial phrase modifying "believes"
- (c) Noun phrase functioning as the subject
- (d) Appositive explaining "identity"

Q.186. In the clause:

"...pretending to offer stability,"

What grammatical structure is "**pretending**" a part of?

- (a) A relative clause
- (b) A passive voice
- (c) A participial phrase
- (d) A finite verb in past tense

Q.187. What is the best synonym for the word "**synthesized**" in the context:

"...the perceived conflict between facticity and transcendence is thus synthesized in the project..."

- (a) Separated
- (b) Rejected
- (c) Unified and integrated
- (d) Overlooked

Q.188. In the passage, what does "contingency" most closely mean in this sentence?

"...exposes its own contingency."

- (a) Necessity
- (b) Unpredictability or lack of certainty
- (c) Permanent stability
- (d) Logical proof

Q.189. What irony does the passage highlight regarding the concept of "**bad faith**"?

- (a) That anxiety leads to a loss of identity
- (b) That claiming a fixed label actually removes one's responsibility and authenticity
- (c) That true freedom is found in following social rules
- (d) That meaning exists before we make choices

SET - 39 [Q .190. to Q .194.]

"The nature of creative labor lies not in simple manufacturing, but in the organic expression of human intent. The artisan, in their engagement with matter, initially posits that the product is a direct extension of internal thought. However, through the mechanism of commerce, they realize that this product is not purely personal but is appropriated by external forces. The intrinsic bond between creator and creation is thus dissolved in the marketplace, demonstrating that value is not the inherent quality of the object but a social relation where the producer surrenders authority over their own output.

This separation evolves through a systemic contradiction, in

which every hour of work, striving to secure survival, deepens the worker's dispossession. The wage-labor dynamic illuminates this: the laborer sells their time to exist, yet in commodifying their energy, they paradoxically erode their own vitality. The owner, in purchasing labor power, accumulates capital but forfeits the authentic experience of creation. Meanwhile, the worker, through collective struggle and realization, attains a heightened class consciousness, proving that dignity is not granted by employment but reclaimed through solidarity and resistance."

Graduate Level 26/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.190. Which of the following best identifies the grammatical role of the phrase "in their engagement with matter" in the sentence:

"The artisan, in their engagement with matter, initially posits that the product is a direct extension of internal thought."

- (a) Adjective modifying "artisan"
- (b) Adverbial phrase modifying "posits"
- (c) Noun phrase functioning as the subject
- (d) Appositive explaining "product"

Q.191. In the clause:

"...striving to secure survival,"

What grammatical structure is "**striving**" a part of?

- (a) A relative clause
- (b) A passive voice
- (c) A participial phrase
- (d) A finite verb in past tense

Q.192. What is the best synonym for the word "**dissolved**" in the context:

"...the intrinsic bond between creator and creation is thus dissolved in the marketplace..."

- (a) Melted chemically
- (b) Strengthened
- (c) Disintegrated or broken
- (d) Explained

Q.193. In the passage, what does "**appropriated**" most closely mean in this sentence?

"...it realizes that this product is not purely personal but is appropriated by external forces."

- (a) Appreciated
- (b) Seized or taken over
- (c) Given away freely
- (d) Destroyed completely

Q.194. What paradox does the passage highlight regarding the wage-labor dynamic?

- (a) That the owner works harder than the laborer
- (b) That working to survive actually depletes the worker's life force
- (c) That products have no value until they are sold
- (d) That solidarity creates more work for the laborer

SET - 40 [Q .195. to Q .199.]

"The understanding of history is always sought in the events or dates that constitute it, as if it were always, in the end, through the collection of facts that the past spoke: through the collection of facts and the certainty of their occurrence. The view of history that we attempt to preserve is rigidly anchored on the document, its archives, its dates, and its neutrality. But to assign history a single Truth is to impose a limit on that past, to furnish it with a final verdict, to freeze the narrative. Such a perspective is born of the empiricist and positivist ideologies that have placed the fact at the center of knowledge, emphasizing its objectivity and permanence. Yet, in reality, history is a reconstruction of every echo, of every fragmented memory. History begins at the moment the Event is set aside, and interpretation speaks—not the Event.

To refuse the absolute Fact is not to refuse reality, but to refuse the tyranny of a single, unbiased account. The past, instead, becomes a field of competing narratives, where truth is neither singular nor absolute. The vitality of history is not located in its occurrence but in its reconstruction; it is the historian, not the Event, who gives shape to the past. This radical displacement shifts the weight from the occurrence to the observer, from the supposed certainty of the archive to the dynamic play of perspectives within the narrative itself."

Graduate Level 28/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.195. "The view of history that we attempt to preserve is rigidly anchored on the document..."

What is the grammatical function of the clause "that we attempt to preserve"?

- (a) Noun clause acting as subject
- (b) Adverbial clause of time
- (c) Relative clause modifying "view"
- (d) Independent clause

Q.196. Which sentence contains a correct use of the passive voice from the passage?

- (a) "Interpretation speaks the meaning of the past."
- (b) "The historian gives shape to the past."
- (c) "History begins when the Event speaks."
- (d) "The past is furnished with a final verdict."

Q.197. What does the word "**rigidly**" most closely mean in the phrase "rigidly anchored on the document"?

- (a) Softly and vaguely
- (b) In a stiff and unchangeable way
- (c) Recently and temporarily
- (d) Happily and willingly

Q.198. What is the best synonym for "**intrinsic**" in this sentence? "The idea of 'objective history' is a construct of academic tradition rather than an intrinsic feature of the past."

- (a) External
- (b) Artificial
- (c) Essential
- (d) Temporary

Q.199. According to the passage, what happens when we refuse the "**absolute Fact**" in history?

- (a) We deny that the past ever happened.
- (b) The past becomes a field of competing narratives.
- (c) The documents lose all their value.
- (d) The historian becomes irrelevant to the process.

SET - 41 [Q .200. to Q .204.]

"Discourse analysis, the framework through which society understands truth, is based on the assumption that power and knowledge are inextricably linked. Institutions take great pains to defend this order, often restricting validity to the concepts that the dominant culture has defined as rational. When history proceeds in this fashion, narratives tend to be linear, reinforcing the established hierarchy rather than questioning it. Yet, over time, subjugated knowledge—historical contents that have been buried or disguised—resurface. Initially, these counter-narratives are dismissed as madness or as deviations to be corrected within the existing disciplinary structure. However, as these voices grow in volume and coherence, they begin to erode the legitimacy of the prevailing authority.

The evolution of such systems is not a straightforward process of liberation, as Enlightenment thinkers might argue, but rather a reorganization of how power operates. Epistemic shifts occur when a new 'regime of truth' emerges—one that is not merely a reform of the old laws but a fundamental restructuring of discipline. This change is not purely legal or moral; it involves a radical change in focus, akin to a microscopic realignment. The transition from public torture to the prison timetable, for

example, did not merely change the method of punishment; it redefined the very target of control from the physical body to the soul."

Graduate Level 29/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.200. What is the best synonym for "**inextricable**" in the sentence:

"Power and knowledge are inextricably linked."

- (a) Separable
- (b) Tangential
- (c) Inseparable
- (d) Temporary

Q.201. What does the phrase "**regime of truth**" imply in this context?

- (a) A government based on honesty
- (b) A system defining what is accepted as reality
- (c) A brief period of scientific discovery
- (d) A rebellion against established laws

Q.202. According to the passage, why does the transition from torture to prison represent a restructuring rather than just a reform?

- (a) Because prisons are more humane than torture.
- (b) Because the legal system stopped using physical force entirely.
- (c) Because it shifted the target of control from the body to the soul.
- (d) Because the government wanted to save money on executions.

Q.203. Identify the voice used in the sentence:

"Counter-narratives are dismissed as madness or as deviations to be corrected within the existing structure."

- (a) Active voice
- (b) Passive voice
- (c) Imperative voice
- (d) Causative voice

Q.204. What type of clause is used in the sentence:

"Institutions often restrict validity to the concepts that the dominant culture has defined as rational."

- (a) Noun clause
- (b) Adverbial clause
- (c) Relative clause
- (d) Independent clause

SET - 42 [Q .205. to Q .209.]

"It is with deep sorrow that we report a severe flood which, late on Tuesday night, destroyed the main bridge of Riverside Village. Although the rescue teams worked tirelessly in the dark, the heavy rain caused the river levels to rise, flooding many farms and cellars. Villagers and farmers watched helplessly as the bridge was swept away. Initial reports suggest that the flood occurred because the drainage channels were blocked by debris, but experts are currently investigating the site. The Town Council has promised a complete upgrade of the drainage system to avoid such tragedies in coming years."

Graduate Level 31/07/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.205. Which tense is mainly used in the passage?

- (a) Future Continuous
- (b) Past Simple
- (c) Present Perfect
- (d) Present Simple

Q.206. Identify the correct passive voice sentence from the passage:

- (a) The rescue teams worked tirelessly.
- (b) The bridge was swept away.
- (c) The heavy rain caused the river to rise.
- (d) Experts are investigating the site.

Q.207. What does the word "**sorrow**" most closely mean?

- (a) Delight
- (b) Grief
- (c) Rage
- (d) Curiosity

Q.208. What is "debris" in the context of the passage?

- (a) Fresh water flowing in the river.
- (b) Scattered pieces of waste or remains.
- (c) New tools used by the council.
- (d) A type of heavy rain.

Q.209. Why does the Town Council plan to upgrade the drainage system?

- (a) To punish the farmers
- (b) To beautify the village
- (c) To avoid such tragedies in coming years
- (d) To destroy the old bridge

SET - 43 [Q .210. to Q .214.]

"It is with profound concern that we observe the rising tide of sedition in the Provinces, where the agitation of radical societies signals a disruption most alarming to the stability of the Realm. Missives arriving at our desk, though frequently of exaggerated temper, suggest that certain Guilds of Artisans, long aggrieved, have commenced a covert correspondence, thereby threatening the fragile Order established by the Magistrates. The yeomanry, while eager for prosperity after lean harvests, rests anxious; their fears ignited by demagogues whose treacherous harangues find fertile ground amongst the destitute.

Meanwhile, at the Exchequer, the Lords are occupied in heated discourse regarding the necessity of curbing public assembly, lest seditious plots render the capital unguarded. It is the conviction of divers prudent statesmen that restraint, exercised with firmness, is the only bulwark against the malice of revolutionary zeal. Subsequent bulletins are anticipated with no small amount of dread."

Graduate Level 02/08/2025 (Shift - 3)

Q.210. Identify the grammatical role of "wherein" in the phrase "**a covert correspondence was commenced, wherein secret plans were laid.**"

- (a) Preposition
- (b) Conjunction
- (c) Adverb
- (d) Interjection

Q.211. What is the closest meaning of "treacherous" as used in the passage?

- (a) Helpful and kind
- (b) Dangerous or deceptive
- (c) Silent and calm
- (d) Brief

Q.212. The term "harangues" most nearly means:

- (a) Gentle whispers
- (b) Aggressive speeches
- (c) Written laws
- (d) Musical performances

Q.213. According to the article, what is the primary conviction of prudent statesmen ?

- (a) To lower taxes for the yeomanry
- (b) To ignore the reports from the Provinces
- (c) To exercise restraint and firmness against revolution
- (d) To dissolve the Guilds immediately

Q.214. In the sentence "**Lest the capital be overtaken by the malice of revolutionary zeal,**" the word "Malice" is:

- (a) Verb
- (b) Adjective
- (c) Noun
- (d) Preposition

SET -44 [Q .215. to Q .217.]

"The concept that energy and matter exhibit a dual nature was first proposed by Louis de Broglie as a logical extension of Quantum Theory. In this framework, particles are not discrete, localized points, as classical mechanics had depicted, but rather described by a mathematical entity known as the wave function. Particles exist in a state of potentiality, and their behavior is

governed not by deterministic laws but by the Schrödinger equation, which evolves smoothly over time. This intrinsic uncertainty within the quantum realm suggests that the outcome of an event is not fixed but probabilistic; what is measured depends entirely on the interaction between the observer and the system.

This framework becomes even more complex when we introduce observation, as debated in the Copenhagen interpretation. Measurement is no longer viewed as a passive discovery of pre-existing facts but rather as the catalyst for the collapse of the wave function into a single reality. Electrons moving around a nucleus exist in superposition—the ability to occupy multiple states simultaneously until measured. This leads to the counterintuitive conclusion that reality is not defined until it is observed: an unobserved particle does not have a specific location, but only a probability of being found in a specific location. This phenomenon, known as quantum indeterminacy, has been verified through experiments like the double-slit test."

Graduate Level 29/08/2025 (Shift - 1)

Q.215. Which of the following best describes the grammatical structure of the sentence:

"This intrinsic uncertainty within the quantum realm suggests that the outcome of an event is not fixed but probabilistic."?

- (a) Simple sentence
- (b) Compound sentence
- (c) Complex sentence
- (d) Compound-complex sentence

Q.216. What is the closest meaning of "superposition" in the context of the passage?

- (a) The collision of two particles in space
- (b) The ability to exist in multiple states at once
- (c) The rapid movement of electrons in orbit
- (d) A fixed point of measurement in a lab

Q.217. In the sentence "**Measurement is no longer viewed as a passive discovery... but rather as the catalyst for the collapse of the wave function...**", what does the word "collapse" most likely refer to?

- (a) The failure of the experiment
- (b) The reduction of probability to a single state
- (c) The physical destruction of the particle
- (d) The breaking down of the microscope

Solutions :-

SET - 36

Sol.176.(a) a

The given sentence talks about a sustainable lifestyle in general, not a specific one previously mentioned. Therefore, the article 'a' will be used before it as it starts with a consonant sound. Hence, 'a' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.177.(c) Renewable energy and recycling are vital for nature. In option (c), the subject 'Renewable energy and recycling' is a plural compound subject and takes the plural verb 'are' according to the subject-verb agreement rule. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.178.(b) Green spaces

(Line/s from the passage - Green spaces provide oxygen, which helps purify the air and sustain life.)

Sol.179.(a) Important - having great significance or value.

Significant - sufficiently great or important to be worthy of

attention.

Useless - not fulfilling the intended purpose.

Tiny - very small.

Rare - not occurring very often.

SET - 37

Sol.180.(a) Our identity is profoundly influenced by memories. (Correct)

(b) A profound influence is also possessed on our identity by memories. (Incorrect Sentence Structure)

(c) Our identity has been influenced profoundly by memories. (Incorrect Tense)

(d) Memories influence our identity profoundly. (Incorrect Sentence Structure)

Sol.181.(a) Researchers argue that memory exists because the mind is constantly seeking to predict the future. (Correct)

(b) Researchers argued that memory existed because the mind was constantly seeking to predict the future. (Incorrect Tense)

(c) Researchers argue memory had existed because the mind constantly sought to predict the future. (Incomplete Sentence)

(d) Researchers have argued that memory exists as the mind constantly looks to predict the future. (Incorrect Tense)

Sol.182.(b) Navigate- to move through or manage a path.

Sol.183.(b) Series - a number of things or events of the same class coming one after another.

Sequence - a particular order in which related things follow each other.

Disorder - a state of confusion.

Chaos - complete disorder and confusion.

Ending - the final part of something.

Sol.184.(a) Because it helps the mind react faster, ensuring safety and survival.

The given passage states that a prepared mind reacts faster, leading to better decisions and safety, which makes survival more probable. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 38

Sol.185.(b) Adverbial phrase modifying "believes"

The phrase "in their search for meaning" provides the context or circumstance under which the individual believes something. It answers the question "when or in what situation does the individual believe?", thereby functioning as an adverbial phrase modifying the verb 'believes'. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.186.(c) A participial phrase

A participial phrase is a group of words that begins with a participle (here, the present participle "pretending") and functions as an adjective. In the given sentence, the phrase describes the noun phrase 'every moment of life'. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.187.(c) Unified and integrated

In the given phrase, synthesized means that the opposing concepts (facticity and transcendence) are brought together into a coherent whole. The conflict is resolved by combining elements into a unified process. Hence, 'unified and integrated' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.188.(b) Unpredictability or lack of certainty

'Contingency' refers to the state of being subject to chance or

not being necessary. In the text, it implies that life's moments are not fixed or stable, but are dependent on circumstances and choices, lacking absolute certainty. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.189.(b) That claiming a fixed label actually removes one's responsibility and authenticity

The given passage explains that by clinging to a defined label (bad faith) to find comfort, the subject paradoxically escapes their own responsibility and denies themselves a fully authentic existence. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 39

Sol.190.(b) Adverbial phrase modifying "posits"

The phrase "in their engagement with matter" expresses the circumstance or context under which the artisan posits (assumes) something. It answers the question "when or in what context does the artisan posit?", thereby functioning as an adverbial phrase modifying the verb 'posits'. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.191.(c) A participial phrase

A participial phrase is a group of words that begins with a participle (here, the present participle "striving") and functions as an adjective, describing a noun or pronoun in the sentence. In the given sentence, the phrase describes the noun phrase 'every hour of work'. Hence, 'a participle phrase' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.192.(c) Disintegrated or broken

In the given phrase, 'dissolved' means that the connection or bond is broken apart or ended. The relationship between the maker and the object is disintegrated by market forces. Hence, 'disintegrated or broken' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.193.(b) Seized or taken over

The word appropriated means that the product is taken for use by others (external forces), often without the creator's full consent or control. It implies a transfer of ownership or control away from the creator. Hence, 'seized or taken over' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.194.(b) That working to survive actually depletes the worker's life force

The given passage states the paradox that the laborer sells their time (life/energy) to exist/survive, yet by turning their energy into a commodity, they erode their own vitality (life force). Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 40

Sol.195.(c) Relative clause modifying "view"

In the given sentence, "that we attempt to preserve" is a relative clause beginning with the relative pronoun 'that' and it modifies the noun 'view'. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.196.(d) "The past is furnished with a final verdict."

This sentence is an example of the passive voice of the simple present tense and follows the structure - "Sing. Subject + is + V₃". Hence, option (d) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.197.(b) In a stiff and unchangeable way

"Rigidly anchored on the document" means the focus is fixed on the document in a way that is inflexible, strict, and allows for no movement, similar to something that is stiff and unyielding. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.198.(c) Essential - belonging naturally; essential.

Intrinsic - belonging naturally; essential.

External - coming from outside.

Artificial - made by human beings rather than occurring naturally.

Temporary - lasting for only a limited period.

Sol.199.(b) The past becomes a field of competing narratives.

When the absolute Fact is refused, the past is no longer restricted to a single, unbiased account. Instead, it opens up to multiple narratives, allowing the historian to shape the understanding of the past rather than the events controlling it. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 41

Sol.200.(c) Inseparable - impossible to separate or untangle.

Inextricable - impossible to disentangle or separate.

Separable - able to be separated.

Tangential - diverging from a previous course; hardly touching.

Temporary - lasting for only a limited period.

Sol.201.(b) A system defining what is accepted as reality

In the passage, a "regime of truth" refers to the specific system or framework that dictates what counts as true or false in a society. It implies a structural way of organizing knowledge and power, rather than just "honesty." Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.202.(c) Because it shifted the target of control from the body to the soul.

According to the passage, the shift was not merely a change in method (reform) but a fundamental redefinition of the target. The text explicitly states it "redefined the very target of control from the physical body to the soul." Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.203.(b) Passive voice

The given sentence is an example of the passive voice of the simple present tense. It follows the structure: "Plural subject + are + V₃ + other words." The sentence highlights the action (dismissed) rather than the doer. Hence, 'passive voice' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.204.(c) Relative clause

In the given sentence, the clause "that the dominant culture has defined as rational" modifies the noun 'concepts'. The clause begins with the relative pronoun 'that' and describes the specific type of concepts being discussed. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 42

Sol.205.(b) Past Simple

The given passage mainly describes events that already happened in the past, using past forms like 'destroyed, worked, caused, watched, and occurred'. Hence, 'Past Simple' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.206.(b) The bridge was swept away.

The given sentence is an example of the passive voice of simple past tense and follows the structure, "Singular subject + was + V₃". Hence, sentence (b) is in the passive voice.

Sol.207.(b) Grief - deep sorrow, especially that caused by someone's death or a tragedy.

Sorrow - a feeling of deep distress.

Delight - great pleasure.

Rage - violent, uncontrollable anger.

Curiosity - a strong desire to know or learn something.

Sol.208.(b) Scattered pieces of waste or remains.

In the given passage, "debris" refers to the waste or loose material that blocked the channels. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.209.(c) To avoid such tragedies in coming years

(Line/s from the passage- The Town Council has promised a complete upgrade of the drainage system to avoid such tragedies in coming years.)

SET - 43

Sol.210.(b) Conjunction

A conjunction is a part of speech that joins two or more words, phrases, or clauses together. In the given phrase, 'wherein' connects the two clauses – "a covert correspondence was commenced" & "secret plans were laid". Hence, 'conjunction' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.211.(b) Dangerous or deceptive - guilty of or involving betrayal or deception.

Treacherous - hazardous because of presenting hidden or unpredictable dangers.

Helpful and kind - showing benevolence.

Silent and calm - lacking noise or agitation.

Brief - of short duration.

Sol.212.(b) Aggressive speeches - lengthy and aggressive speeches.

Harangues - intense verbal attacks or critical speeches.

Gentle whispers - soft spoken words.

Written laws - statutes passed by a legislature.

Musical performances - entertainment involving music.

Sol.213.(c) To exercise restraint and firmness against revolution

The given passage states that prudent statesmen believe "restraint, exercised with firmness, is the only bulwark against the malice of revolutionary zeal." Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.214.(c) Noun

A noun is a word that refers to a person, place, thing, quality, idea, or feeling. In the given sentence, 'malice' is a noun denoting the desire to harm others or the quality of being malevolent. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 44

Sol.215.(c) Complex sentence

'That' is a subordinating conjunction used to form complex sentences in which there is a dependent clause and an independent clause. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.216.(b) Superposition - The ability to exist in multiple states at once.

Sol.217.(b) The reduction of probability to a single state

The word "collapse" in the sentence refers to the transition from a state of potentiality (multiple possibilities) to a single reality, as mentioned in the passage where it states that the wave function becomes "a single reality." Hence, "reduction of probability to a single state" is the most appropriate answer.



SSC Stenographer 2025 Tier - I

SET - 45 [Q .218. to Q .222.]

The rise of e-commerce has dramatically reshaped retail landscapes around the world. Consumers now enjoy unprecedented convenience, i.e., with only a click, we can compare prices, read reviews, and deliver goods directly to their doors. Brick-and-mortar stores, in contrast, must contend with higher overheads - rent, utilities, and staffing - that online retailers often avoid. Many physical shops have adopted "omnichannel" strategies to stay competitive, integrating their online and in-store experiences. For example, customers might order online and pick up in - store or use a mobile app to check real-time stock levels before visiting. However, some challenges still persist for small retailers because they lack the technical expertise or capital to develop user-friendly websites, and excessive reliance on third-party delivery services can erode profit margins. Moreover, the environmental impact of rapid shipping - packaging waste and increased carbon emissions - is increasingly under scrutiny. As e-commerce continues its ascent, the most successful retailers will combine digital innovation with sustainable practices and a personalized customer experience.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.218. What is the primary purpose of this passage?

- (a) To advocate for brick-and-mortar retail over e-commerce
- (b) To describe how omnichannel strategies are best
- (c) To examine both opportunities and challenges in modern retail
- (d) To explain why delivery services are harmful

Q.219. In context, the word "overheads" most nearly means:

- (a) Profits
- (b) Fixed expenses
- (c) Revenues
- (d) Discounts

Q.220. According to the passage, which of the following is NOT cited as a challenge for small retailers?

- (a) Lack of technical expertise
- (b) High utility bills
- (c) Dependence on delivery services
- (d) Environmental scrutiny

Q.221. The tone of the passage can best be described as:

- (a) Alarmist
- (b) Analytical
- (c) Enthusiastic
- (d) Sarcastic

Q.222. Which inference is best supported by the passage?

- (a) All retailers will eventually go fully online.
- (b) Personalized experiences are key to future retail success.
- (c) Third-party delivery is always unprofitable.
- (d) Packaging waste has minimal impact on consumers.

SET - 46 [Q .223. to Q .227.]

Wildlife conservation has increased in importance since governments and NGOs have realized that locals are vital guardians of the environment. Instead of mandating top-down orders, successful initiatives recruit villagers to protect threatened species, serve as informants, and generate income from ecotourism. In other parts of Africa and Asia, community rangers are taught tracking and first aid, while women's organizations produce handicrafts out of sustainable forest products. These programs not only restrict poaching but also create ownership and pride in the maintenance of biodiversity. There are still obstacles, however: low funding levels, human-wildlife conflict, and uncertain land-use rights can undo

success. Continued dialogue between stakeholders and equitable benefit-sharing mechanisms are essential in guaranteeing that conservation outcomes are directed to community well-being.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.223. What is the primary focus of the passage?

- (a) Criticize eco-tourism for harming wildlife
- (b) Describe the role of communities in conservation
- (c) Explain how poachers operate
- (d) Advocate for stricter government enforcement

Q.224. In context, the phrase "top-down regulations" most nearly means:

- (a) Rules created by local villagers
- (b) Policies imposed by higher authorities
- (c) Guidelines developed by scientists
- (d) Suggestions from tourists

Q.225. According to the passage, which activity helps villagers earn income?

- (a) Poaching endangered species
- (b) Crafting handicrafts from sustainable Products
- (c) Clearing forests for agriculture
- (d) Mining minerals

Q.226. Which challenge is NOT mentioned as affecting community conservation?

- (a) Human-wildlife conflicts
- (b) Inadequate funding
- (c) Climate change
- (d) Unclear land-use rights

Q.227. The tone of the passage is best described as:

- (a) Pessimistic
- (b) Promotional
- (c) Objective
- (d) Sarcastic

SET - 47 [Q .228. to Q .232.]

Good public transport networks are the pillars of urban sustainability. Buses, trams, and metro lines can transport big groups of passengers without relying so much on private cars—and therefore eliminating traffic snarls and emissions. Integrated fares across modes of travel make it easy to move around: one ticket could pay for bus, train, and bike-share travel. Spending money on exclusive lanes and priority signaling also makes them faster and more dependable. Nonetheless, constructing and retaining such infrastructure requires capital and long-term vision. Equity issues are also important: lines need to serve low-income communities along with commercial hubs so that all citizens have a benefit. Finally, when properly planned, public transportation promotes economic efficiency, social mobility, and a cleaner city.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.228. What is the central idea of the passage?

- (a) Public transport is outdated in modern cities
- (b) Investment in roads for private vehicles is more practical
- (c) A strong public transport system is essential for sustainable and inclusive cities
- (d) Public transport is mostly beneficial for tourists

Q.229. According to the passage, integrated fare systems:

- (a) Create financial burden for low- income riders
- (b) Make switching between travel modes easier
- (c) Are only for long-distance travel
- (d) Encourage use of private vehicles

Q.230. As per the passage, what is needed to maintain strong public transport?

- (a) Minimal regulation

- (b) Frequent tech upgrades
- (c) Sufficient funding and long-term planning
- (d) Higher taxes on private vehicles

Q.231. How does public transport contribute to equity?

- (a) By keeping fares high
- (b) By focusing only on commercial zones
- (c) By connecting low-income communities with wealthy areas
- (d) By offering free rides on weekends

Q.232. What is the tone of the passage?

- (a) Skeptical
- (b) Analytical and supportive
- (c) Neutral
- (d) Aggressive

SET - 48 [Q .233. to Q .237.]

Universal immunization campaigns have eradicated or controlled fatal conditions such as smallpox and polio. Mass immunization relies on cold-chain availability: vaccines have to be stored at precise temperatures from manufacturing through inoculation. Solar-powered refrigerators and insulated containers are lifelines for remote locations. Door-to-door interactions by community health workers educate households regarding dosage routines and myths. Vaccine hesitancy fueled by misinformation is also a major obstacle to herd immunity. Campaigns of public education—capitalizing on radio, social media, and school initiatives—seek to revive public faith in science. Preserving accessibility and communication in an open nature is crucial in order to secure public health.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.233. What does "cold-chain logistics" refer to in the passage ?

- (a) Transporting vaccines under controlled temperatures
- (b) Selling vaccines in cold climates
- (c) Developing new vaccine formulas
- (d) Distributing medicines door-to-door

Q.234. According to the passage, which method helps maintain vaccine potency in remote areas ?

- (a) Air-conditioned cars
- (b) Solar-powered refrigerators
- (c) Vaccine-heated containers
- (d) Underground storage

Q.235. Vaccine hesitancy is primarily caused by :

- (a) Lack of refrigerators
- (b) Misinformation
- (c) Cold-chain failures
- (d) Overproduction

Q.236. Which strategy is NOT mentioned as part of public-education initiatives ?

- (a) Radio broadcasts
- (b) Social-media influencers
- (c) School programs
- (d) Financial incentives

Q.237. The passage suggests that to protect public health, it is essential to :

- (a) Eliminate door-to-door visits
- (b) Halt solar-powered technology
- (c) Ensure equitable access and clear communication
- (d) Focus solely on urban areas

SET - 49 [Q .238. to Q .242.]

Microfinance institutions (MFIs) have become crucial agents for advancing financial inclusion in rural areas. Through extending small loans and savings accounts to people who don't have access to conventional banks, MFIs empower entrepreneurs—most often women—to initiate or scale up microenterprises. In most villages, these loans support poultry farming, handloom weaving, or tiny retailing outlets. MFIs go

beyond credit by regularly offering financial education training, teaching borrowers to cope with cash flows and interest charges. Critics warn, however, that excessive interest rates and repayment pressure can result in over-indebtedness. To avoid such risks, some MFIs limit interest rates and spread repayment terms. Research indicates that when complemented by market linkages—such as guaranteed buyers for fruits and vegetables—microfinance can trigger sustainable economic growth and poverty reduction.

SSC Stenographer 06/08/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.238. The primary function of microfinance institutions, according to the passage, is to:

- (a) Charge high interest rates to rural borrowers
- (b) Provide large corporate loans
- (c) Offer financial services to those excluded from traditional banking systems
- (d) Regulate national monetary policy

Q.239. In the context of the above passage, "microenterprises" most nearly means:

- (a) Multinational corporations
- (b) Small-scale businesses
- (c) Government agencies
- (d) Family-owned farms

Q.240. Which benefit of MFIs is mentioned besides lending money ?

- (a) Granting land titles
- (b) Financial literacy training
- (c) Tax exemptions
- (d) Import-export facilitation

Q.241. What is a key criticism of microfinance highlighted in the passage?

- (a) It fails to reach women borrowers.
- (b) It offers only savings accounts.
- (c) High interest and repayment pressure can cause debt.
- (d) It mandates market linkages.

Q.242. According to the author, sustainable impact occurs when microfinance is combined with:

- (a) High interest rates
- (b) Market linkages
- (c) Shorter loan tenures
- (d) Government bailouts

SET - 50 [Q .243. to Q .247.]

As artificial intelligence (AI) technologies continue to proliferate across every sector of human activity, the ethical implications of their deployment have become a matter of urgent concern. Once relegated to the realm of speculative fiction, AI now permeates decision-making in fields as diverse as healthcare, finance, education, and criminal justice. While proponents argue that AI can increase efficiency, reduce human bias, and democratize access to services, critics warn of the potential for algorithmic discrimination, erosion of privacy, and the deepening of existing social inequalities.

At the heart of the debate lies a fundamental tension between technological progress and moral responsibility. Machines, no matter how sophisticated, lack consciousness and intrinsic values; they merely execute instructions based on data inputs and programmed algorithms. Thus, when an AI system makes a life-altering decision—such as denying a loan application or predicting a defendant's likelihood of reoffending—it is not the machine itself that is accountable, but the human architects behind its creation and training.

Moreover, the opacity of many AI systems, often referred to as the "black box" problem, poses a significant ethical challenge. When even developers cannot fully explain how a machine arrived at a given outcome, the prospect of ensuring fairness, transparency, and accountability becomes deeply problematic.

Addressing these concerns will require not only technical innovations, such as explainable AI, but also rigorous interdisciplinary collaboration between engineers, ethicists, policymakers, and the public.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.243. Which of the following correctly identifies the tense used predominantly in the first paragraph ?

- (a) Past perfect (b) Present continuous
(c) Present perfect continuous (d) Present simple

Q.244. "At the heart of the debate lies a fundamental tension between technological progress and moral responsibility."

- (a) Compound (b) Complex
(c) Simple (d) Compound-Complex

Q.245. What does the word "proliferate" most nearly mean as used in the passage ?

- (a) Decline slowly (b) Spread rapidly
(c) Change unpredictably (d) Improve steadily

Q.246. In the context of the passage, the phrase "algorithmic discrimination" most likely refers to:

- (a) Computers correcting human mistakes.
(b) AI systems treating individuals unfairly based on biased programming.
(c) AI systems achieving perfect objectivity.
(d) The classification of data without errors.

Q.247. According to the passage, what is one major obstacle to ensuring fairness and accountability in AI systems ?

- (a) The high cost of building AI models.
(b) The limited availability of data scientists.
(c) The inability to fully explain how AI systems reach conclusions.
(d) The lack of government funding.

SET - 51 [Q .248. to Q .252.]

Changes that seem small and unimportant at first will compound into remarkable results if you're willing to stick with them for years. We often convince ourselves that massive success requires massive action. Whether it's losing weight, building a business, or learning a new skill, we put pressure on ourselves to make some earth-shattering improvement that everyone will notice.

However, improvement by just 1 percent each day may not be noticeable in the moment, but over time it can be far more meaningful. The same way that money compounds with interest, the effects of your habits multiply as you repeat them. The outcomes you see in your life today are often the result of small choices made over time, rather than dramatic changes.

This is why habits are the compound interest of self-improvement. The longer you stick with them, the greater the returns. But just as positive habits can compound in your favor, negative habits can compound against you. A slight slip in discipline today may not seem like a big deal, but if repeated, it can steer you in a completely different direction.

Success, then, is not a single event-it is the result of daily choices, made consistently over time.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.248. Identify the sentence with the correct use of subject-verb agreement:

- (a) The effects of your habits multiplies as you repeat them.
(b) The outcomes you see in your life today is often the result of small choices made over time.

- (c) The effects of your habits multiply as you repeat them.
(d) The outcomes of your daily decisions determines your long-term success.

Q.249. "Changes that seem small and unimportant at first will compound into remarkable results if you're willing to stick with them for years."

- (a) To decrease gradually
(b) To mix different elements
(c) To accumulate and grow over time
(d) To remain constant

Q.250. "A slight slip in discipline today may not seem like a big deal, but if repeated, it can steer you in a completely different direction."

- (a) Commitment (b) Carelessness
(c) Determination (d) Focus

Q.251. What is the main idea of the passage?

- (a) Success comes from making one major change in life.
(b) Small daily improvements, when repeated consistently, lead to significant long-term results.
(c) Negative habits have no real impact unless they are extreme.
(d) Success is mostly determined by luck rather than effort.

Q.252. What type of pronoun is the word "This" in the sentence, "This is why habits are the compound interest of self-improvement."?

- (a) Demonstrative pronoun (b) Reflexive pronoun
(c) Abstract pronoun (d) Subjective pronoun

SET - 52 [Q .253. to Q .257.]

Freedom of speech is a cornerstone of democratic societies, allowing individuals to express ideas, question authority, and promote change. However, in the digital world, this right encounters complex challenges. Social media platforms have become arenas where opinions can be voiced instantly-but also where hate speech, misinformation, and cyberbullying thrive. Balancing the right to speak freely with the responsibility to prevent harm is now a pressing debate. Should platforms censor harmful content, or would that violate freedom? While some argue that regulation is essential to protect vulnerable groups, others fear it might lead to suppression of dissent. The problem deepens when private companies-not elected bodies - decide what speech is allowed or banned. Striking the right balance requires thoughtful policies, digital literacy, and legal frameworks rooted in both human rights and public safety. In a world where words travel faster than thought, protecting free speech without enabling harm may be one of the defining tests of modern democracy.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.253. What central conflict is explored in the passage?

- (a) Law vs. religion (b) Profit vs. loss
(c) Freedom vs. online harm (d) Privacy vs. piracy

Q.254. Why is regulation of speech on social media controversial?

- (a) It is illegal in all democracies
(b) It gives too much power to users
(c) It may suppress dissenting voices
(d) It slows down communication

Q.255. What is the concern about private companies controlling speech ?

- (a) They are too small to influence politics

- (b) They lack legal authority or accountability
- (c) They promote academic debates
- (d) Not Answered

Q.256. According to the author, what is required to resolve this conflict ?

- (a) Removing all harmful users
- (b) Allowing complete freedom
- (c) Combining rights with safety through law and literacy
- (d) Banning social media worldwide

Q.257. What tone does the author adopt in the passage?

- (a) Dismissive (b) Alarmist
- (c) Balanced and reflective (d) Aggressive

SET - 53 [Q .258. to Q .262.]

In the age of endless options-from streaming services to social media platforms-modern individuals face what psychologists call "decision fatigue." Unlike earlier generations who had limited choices, today's youth are constantly required to decide: what to watch, whom to follow, what to share, and how to respond. While freedom of choice is often celebrated, too many choices can lead to stress, dissatisfaction, and even paralysis. Ironically, abundance can become overwhelming. Algorithms, designed to predict preferences, often narrow exposure rather than broaden it, creating digital bubbles. People may feel in control, yet their choices are subtly shaped by unseen patterns. Over time, the constant need to choose can drain mental energy, leaving individuals anxious or indifferent. True digital freedom may lie not in limitless options, but in mindful engagement and setting personal boundaries. Recognising when to choose-and when to step back-could be the new wisdom of the connected age
SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.258. What is the main issue discussed in the passage ?

- (a) Rise of social media trends
- (b) Overuse of mobile apps
- (c) Stress caused by excessive digital choices
- (d) Lack of internet literacy

Q.259. What does the author imply about algorithms ?

- (a) They always give better choices
- (b) They expand one's interests
- (c) They limit exposure to diverse content
- (d) They reduce online ads

Q.260. What paradox is presented in the passage ?

- (a) Choice leads to control but also exhaustion
- (b) Technology helps only the rich
- (c) More apps mean less productivity
- (d) Less data brings more security

Q.261. According to the author, what may be a solution ?

- (a) Faster internet plans
- (b) Reducing social media apps
- (c) Mindful engagement and limits
- (d) Following more influencers

Q.262. What is the tone of the passage ?

- (a) Sarcastic (b) Cautionary (c) Indifferent (d) Aggressive

SET - 54 [Q .263. to Q .267.]

Much of the discussion in this book is about biases of intuition. However, the focus on biases does not mean that intuition is always wrong-far from it. Most of the time, the quick judgments

of our intuitive mind, what I call System 1, are accurate enough to help us navigate the world. This system operates automatically and quickly, with little or no effort.

On the other hand, System 2 is the slower, more deliberate mode of thinking. It allocates attention to effortful mental activities, such as solving complex problems or evaluating logical arguments. System 2 is more methodical and rational, but it is also lazier-it prefers to endorse the intuitions of System 1 rather than question them.

This division of labour works well most of the time, but it also creates predictable errors. Because System 1 is prone to biases and snap judgments, we often make decisions that are not as rational as we believe. Understanding these two systems can help us recognize when we are relying too much on intuition and when we need to engage in more deliberate thinking.

SSC Stenographer 07/08/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.263. Identify the sentence with correct subject-verb agreement:

- (a) The quick judgments of our intuitive mind, what I call System 1, is accurate enough to help us navigate the world.
- (b) This division of labor work well most of the time, but it also creates predictable errors.
- (c) Understanding these two systems can helps us recognize when we are relying too much on intuition.
- (d) System 2 allocates attention to effortful mental activities, such as solving complex problems or evaluating logical arguments.

Q.264. Choose the sentence that correctly uses a relative pronoun:

- (a) System 1 is the intuitive mode of thinking, who operates automatically and quickly.
- (b) The biases, which influence our judgments, often lead to predictable errors.
- (c) Understanding the two systems, whom have different roles, is crucial for decision-making.
- (d) The effortful mental activities whose System 2 performs include solving complex problems.

Q.265. What is the meaning of the word "deliberate" in the sentence:

"System 2 is the slower, more deliberate mode of thinking."

- (a) Accidental (b) Careful and intentional
- (c) Quick and effortless (d) Biased

Q.266. Choose the best synonym for the word "endorse" in the sentence:

"System 2 is more methodical and rational, but it is also lazier-it prefers to endorse the intuitions of System 1 rather than question them."

- (a) Approve (b) Reject (c) Criticize (d) Delay

Q.267. According to the passage, what is one drawback of System 1 thinking ?

- (a) It always leads to incorrect decisions.
- (b) It requires too much mental effort.
- (c) It can be prone to biases and snap judgments.
- (d) It completely replaces System 2 in decision-making.

SET - 55 [Q .268. to Q .272.]

In a small village, a government school has become an example of clean energy use. The school uses solar panels to run fans, lights, and even computers. This helps the school save money on electricity bills. The saved money is used to buy books and

improve classrooms. The teachers also explain to students how solar energy works and why it is good for the planet. Students learn that solar power does not cause pollution like coal or petrol. The school has also inspired nearby houses to install solar panels. This change has made the village cleaner and more aware of the environment. Even on cloudy days, the solar battery stores enough power to keep the school running. With small steps like this, more schools and homes can help protect nature and build a better future.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.268. What energy source does the school use?

- (a) Petrol (b) Wind (c) Solar (d) Gas

Q.269. What does the school do with saved electricity money?

- (a) Build a playground (b) Buy food
(c) Buy books and improve classrooms (d) Hire more teachers

Q.270. Why is solar energy better than coal?

- (a) It is cheaper to burn (b) It does not cause pollution
(c) It is easier to store (d) It is available in bottles

Q.271. What did the school inspire villagers to do?

- (a) Use less water (b) Buy new uniforms
(c) Install solar panels (d) Visit the school more

Q.272. What helps the school on cloudy days?

- (a) Electricity from the city (b) Fans from other schools
(c) Solar batteries (d) Teachers' phones

SET - 56 [Q .273. to Q .277.]

The rise of genetic engineering has redefined what is scientifically possible, but not necessarily what is ethically acceptable. While gene editing offers hope in treating inherited diseases and improving crop resilience, it also raises profound moral questions. Should we edit genes to enhance intelligence or physical ability? Where do we draw the line between therapy and enhancement? These questions remain unsettled. Some argue that altering the human genome for non-medical reasons may lead to a new form of inequality—where the genetically modified have social advantages over others. Others fear unintended consequences: once a gene is changed, its effects may ripple through generations. Science often moves faster than legislation, leaving ethical frameworks lagging behind. True progress lies not in what we can do, but in what we choose to do responsibly. As with all powerful tools, genetic engineering demands caution, reflection, and a shared sense of human values.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 1)

Q.273. What is the central concern of the passage?

- (a) Costs of gene therapy
(b) Government control of science
(c) Ethical use of genetic engineering
(d) Advances in medical devices

Q.274. What does the author suggest about using genes to enhance traits?

- (a) It improves global health (b) It is encouraged by law
(c) It risks creating inequality (d) It always benefits society

Q.275. Why are ethical frameworks struggling to keep up?

- (a) Scientists disagree (b) Public lacks interest
(c) Laws are faster than research (d) Science progresses rapidly

Q.276. What does the author imply about gene editing's

long-term impact?

- (a) It is fully reversible (b) It can affect future generations
(c) It has no proven results (d) It only benefits the rich

Q.277. Which phrase best captures the author's message?

- (a) "Edit now, regret later" (b) "Act fast and innovate"
(c) "Caution must guide progress" (d) "All science is safe"

SET - 57 [Q .278. to Q .282.]

Theme: The Dandi March

Sector: Indian History / Freedom Movement In 1930, Mahatma Gandhi started a peaceful protest called the Dandi March. He and his followers walked 240 kilometers from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi, a village near the sea. The purpose of the march was to protest the British law that taxed salt. Salt is a basic need for everyone, and Gandhi believed it was unfair to make people pay for it. During the march, more and more people joined him. The British government tried to stop the movement, but Gandhi remained calm and peaceful. He made salt from the sea at Dandi, breaking the law in a non-violent way. The Dandi March became a strong symbol of India's fight for freedom. It showed the world that peaceful protest could be powerful. Even today, it is remembered as a brave step in India's struggle for independence.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.278. Who led the Dandi March ?

- (a) Subhas Chandra Bose (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Bhagat Singh (d) Mahatma Gandhi

Q.279. Why was the march started ?

- (a) To support education (b) To protest salt tax
(c) To celebrate independence (d) To fight a war

Q.280. How did Gandhi break the law?

- (a) By fighting soldiers (b) By leaving the country
(c) By making salt from the sea (d) By closing schools

Q.281. What was the distance covered in the march?

- (a) 100 km (b) 500 km (c) 240 km (d) 50 km

Q.282. What does the Dandi March symbolize today?

- (a) Peaceful protest and courage (b) Use of violence in freedom
(c) Marching for exercise (d) Tax collection by British

SET - 58 [Q .283. to Q .287.]

As algorithms increasingly curate our digital experiences — what we read, watch, buy, or even whom we date — they quietly shape our perception of the world. This phenomenon, known as "algorithmic living," promises efficiency but risks eroding autonomy. When choices are filtered through predictive systems, personal agency may weaken, and individuals might mistake convenience for control. Moreover, algorithmic personalization often traps users in feedback loops, reinforcing existing preferences and limiting exposure to diverse perspectives. Over time, this can lead to cognitive narrowing, where users become less open to alternative views or new ideas. While algorithms are not inherently harmful, their unchecked influence raises ethical concerns about manipulation and passive consumption. True digital well-being demands critical awareness — not of the machine, but of how we engage with it. In a world increasingly optimized for us, the question is not what the algorithm shows, but whether we are still choosing to look beyond it.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 2)

Q.283. What is the main concern of "algorithmic living"?

- (a) Faster online shopping
- (b) Decline in physical activity
- (c) Loss of autonomy due to filtered choices
- (d) Increased cost of internet

Q.284. What does the term "feedback loop" imply in the passage?

- (a) Randomized search results
- (b) Repeated exposure to similar content
- (c) Feedback from social media users
- (d) Technological malfunctions

Q.285. How does algorithmic living affect thinking over time?

- (a) It enhances creative thinking
- (b) It encourages scientific research
- (c) It narrows perspective and reduces openness
- (d) It develops emotional intelligence

Q.286. What is suggested as a way to maintain digital well-being?

- (a) Ignore all online content
- (b) Follow only algorithmic suggestions
- (c) Practice critical engagement
- (d) Increase screen time

Q.287. What is the tone of the passage?

- (a) Casual and humorous
- (b) Cautious and reflective
- (c) Dismissive and skeptical
- (d) Optimistic and enthusiastic

SET - 59 [Q .288. to Q .292.]

In today's digital age, convenience often comes at the cost of privacy. Every time a user browses a website, clicks a link, or uses an app, their data is collected —sometimes without their knowledge. Companies use this information to target ads, predict behavior, or even sell insights to third parties. While this can lead to better services, it also raises ethical concerns. Who controls this data? How is it stored, and can users truly opt out? Many people accept terms and conditions without reading them, unknowingly giving permission for data tracking. Some countries have passed laws to protect user data, but implementation remains weak. As surveillance tools grow smarter, the line between public and private becomes blurred. Individuals must now learn to balance the benefits of technology with the right to privacy—a task that requires awareness, regulation, and responsible digital behavior.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.288. What is the main concern raised in the passage?

- (a) Lack of internet speed
- (b) High cost of mobile data
- (c) Threats to digital privacy
- (d) Overuse of technology

Q.289. According to the passage, how is user data often collected?

- (a) Only with government approval
- (b) Through printed forms
- (c) Without users being fully aware
- (d) After signing hardcopy documents

Q.290. What does the passage say about laws protecting data?

- (a) They are strong and global
- (b) They are strict in all countries
- (c) They exist but are poorly enforced
- (d) They are unnecessary

Q.291. What is one positive use of user data mentioned in the passage?

- (a) Reducing screen time
- (b) Improving service experiences
- (c) Blocking global access
- (d) Avoiding social media

Q.292. What does the author suggest is needed to protect privacy?

- (a) Avoiding all apps
- (b) Stronger surveillance tools
- (c) Awareness and responsible behavior
- (d) Free mobile phones for all

SET - 60 [Q .293. to Q .297.]

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is gradually transforming the way students learn. From virtual tutors to personalized learning paths, AI helps identify each learner's strengths and weaknesses. With the help of data, AI systems can suggest specific topics where students need improvement. Schools are also using AI chatbots to answer basic queries, reducing the pressure on teachers. However, experts warn that over-dependence on AI may limit critical thinking. If students rely too much on machines for answers, they may lose problem-solving skills. There are also concerns about data privacy, especially when student performance data is stored online. Despite these issues, many educators believe AI can be a useful tool when used wisely. Like any technology, the key lies in balancing human guidance with machine efficiency.

SSC Stenographer 08/08/2025 (Shift 3)

Q.293. What does AI mainly help with in education?

- (a) Giving marks
- (b) Personalizing learning
- (c) Hiring teachers
- (d) Fixing school buildings

Q.294. What is a possible risk of overusing AI?

- (a) Higher costs
- (b) Fewer classrooms
- (c) Poor thinking skills
- (d) Better results

Q.295. Why are AI chatbots used in schools?

- (a) To monitor cameras
- (b) To take exams
- (c) To answer student questions
- (d) To conduct interviews

Q.296. What is a concern related to student data?

- (a) Attendance drops
- (b) Internet speed
- (c) Data privacy
- (d) Exam cheating

Q.297. What is the author's final advice?

- (a) Replace teachers
- (b) Use only AI
- (c) Balance tech and human input
- (d) Avoid all AI

Solutions :-

SET - 45

Sol.218.(c) to examine both opportunities and challenges in modern retail.

It can be inferred from the passage that the primary aim of the passage is to examine both opportunities and challenges in modern retail. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.219.(b) fixed expenses

In the passage, "overheads" refers to costs like rent, utilities, and staffing that physical stores must pay regularly. These are fixed operating expenses, not profits, revenues, or discounts.

Sol.220.(b) High utility bills

The passage says small retailers face problems like lack of technical expertise, reliance on delivery services, and profit margin issues. It also mentions environmental impact as a concern. But high utility bills are mentioned for brick-and-mortar

stores, not specifically as a challenge for small retailers.

Sol.221.(b) Analytical

In an analytical tone, the author looks at all the facts and reasons about a topic and explains them in a clear and organized way.

Sol.222.(b) Personalized experiences are key to future retail success.

The passage concludes that the most successful retailers will combine digital innovation with sustainable practices and a personalized customer experience. Hence, the inference given in option (b) is best supported by the passage.

SET - 46

Sol.223.(b) Describe the role of communities in conservation

The given passage explains how locals are involved as guardians of the environment, trained as rangers, engaged in handicrafts, and included in ecotourism. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.224.(b) Policies imposed by higher authorities

In the given passage Top-down implies directives coming from higher authorities, rather than being developed or followed by the locals themselves. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.225.(b) Crafting handicrafts from sustainable products

The given passage states that women's organizations in Africa and Asia "produce handicrafts out of sustainable forest products". Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.226.(c) Climate change

In the given passage Climate change is not mentioned anywhere. Hence, "climate change" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.227.(c) Objective

In an objective tone, the author presents facts and examples carefully, highlighting both successes and challenges, and explains the topic clearly without bias. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 47

Sol.228.(c) A strong public transport system is essential for sustainable and inclusive cities

The given passage emphasizes the importance of well-planned public transport in reducing traffic and emissions, promoting social equity, and supporting economic efficiency, highlighting its role in creating sustainable and inclusive urban environments. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.229.(b) Make switching between travel modes easier

The given passage states that "one ticket could pay for bus, train, and bike-share travel," showing that integrated fares simplify moving across different modes of public transport. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.230.(c) Sufficient funding and long-term planning

(Line/s from the passage - constructing and retaining such infrastructure requires capital and long-term vision.)

Sol.231.(c) By connecting low-income communities with wealthy areas

(Line/s from the passage - lines need to serve low-income

communities along with commercial hubs so that all citizens have a benefit.)

Sol.232.(b) Analytical and supportive

In an analytical tone, the author examines facts, reasons, or evidence carefully, breaking down the topic to explain it clearly and logically. When combined with a supportive tone, it shows that the author favors or recommends a particular perspective, as in this passage on public transport.

SET - 48

Sol.233.(a) Transporting vaccines under controlled temperatures

Cold-chain logistics refers to maintaining vaccines at specific temperatures during storage and transport. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.234.(b) Solar-powered refrigerators

(Line/s from the passage- Solar-powered refrigerators and insulated containers are lifelines for remote locations.)

Sol.235.(b) Misinformation

(Line/s from the passage- Vaccine hesitancy fueled by misinformation is also a major obstacle to herd immunity.)

Sol.236.(d) Financial incentives

(Line/s from the passage- Campaigns of public education—capitalizing on radio, social media, and school initiatives— seek to revive public faith in science.)

Sol.237.(c) Ensure equitable access and clear communication

To protect public health, it is important to make vaccines accessible to all and ensure that communication about them is clear and open.

SET - 49

Sol.238.(c) Offer financial services to those excluded from traditional banking systems

The primary function of microfinance institutions is to extend small loans and savings services to individuals who are excluded from formal banking systems, especially in rural areas. This helps them start or expand small businesses.

Sol.239.(b) Small-scale businesses

The term "microenterprises" refers to very small-scale businesses such as poultry farming, weaving, or tiny retail shops, which are often supported through microfinance loans.

Sol.240.(b) Financial literacy training

Apart from providing loans, MFIs also give financial literacy training to borrowers, helping them understand how to manage cash flow and repay interest responsibly.

Sol.241.(c) High interest and repayment pressure can cause debt

(Line/s from the passage- Critics warn, however, that excessive interest rates and repayment pressure can result in over-indebtedness.)

Sol.242.(b) Market linkages

Sustainable impact happens when microfinance is not limited to lending but is supported with market linkages.

SET - 50

Sol.243.(d) Present simple

The first paragraph predominantly uses the present simple tense

to describe general truths and ongoing realities. It shows facts and realities, not past or continuous actions. Hence, 'Present simple' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.244.(c) simple

In the given sentence, there is only one independent clause that expresses a complete thought. There are no dependent clauses or multiple independent clauses. Therefore, it is a simple sentence.

Sol.245.(b) Spread rapidly

'Proliferate' means to increase or spread quickly. The passage states that AI technologies "continue to proliferate across every sector", indicating rapid growth and expansion. Hence, 'Spread rapidly' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.246.(b) AI systems treating individuals unfairly based on biased programming.

In the given passage, "algorithmic discrimination" refers to AI systems making decisions that unfairly disadvantage certain individuals due to biased data or programming. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.247.(c) The inability to fully explain how AI systems reach conclusions.

(Line/s from the passage - When even developers cannot fully explain how a machine arrived at a given outcome, the prospect of ensuring fairness, transparency, and accountability becomes deeply problematic.)

SET - 51

Sol.248.(c) The effects of your habits multiply as you repeat them.

The subject "effects" is plural, so the verb should also be plural (multiply). The sentence given in option (c) correctly follows subject-verb agreement rules.

Sol.249.(c) To accumulate and grow over time.

In the given context, 'compound' refers to small changes building up gradually to create significant results over time. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.250.(b) Carelessness - lack of attention or thought.

Discipline - controlled behaviour and training to follow rules.

Commitment - a promise or strong dedication to something.

Determination - firmness of purpose and strong will.

Focus - concentrated attention on something.

Sol.251.(b) Small daily improvements, when repeated consistently, lead to significant long-term results.

The passage emphasizes that even minor, consistent actions compound over time, producing remarkable results, much like how money grows with compound interest. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.252.(a) Demonstrative pronoun

"This" is a demonstrative pronoun because it points to or refers to a specific idea. In the given passage, 'This' refers to the reason why habits are the compound interest of self improvement. Hence, 'demonstrative pronoun' is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 52

Sol.253.(c) Freedom vs. online harm

The passage discusses the tension between the right to freedom of speech and the challenges posed by harmful content

online, such as hate speech, misinformation, and cyberbullying. The central conflict is about protecting free expression while preventing harm in the digital world. Hence, 'Freedom vs. online harm' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.254.(c) It may suppress dissenting voices. It can be inferred from the passage that regulating speech on social media is controversial because while it aims to prevent harm, it can also lead to the suppression of legitimate opinions and dissent, raising concerns about censorship and misuse of power. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.255.(b) They lack legal authority or accountability.

The passage highlights that private companies, unlike elected bodies, decide what speech is allowed or banned, which raises concerns because they are not accountable to the public or bound by law in the same way governments are. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.256.(c) Combining rights with safety through law and literacy.

The passage emphasizes that striking a balance between freedom of speech and preventing online harm requires thoughtful policies, legal frameworks, and digital literacy. This approach ensures rights are protected while minimizing potential harm. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.257.(c) Balanced and reflective

The author adopts a balanced and reflective tone, presenting both the importance of freedom of speech and the challenges posed by harmful online content, while suggesting thoughtful solutions like digital literacy and legal frameworks.

SET - 53

Sol.258.(c) Stress caused by excessive digital choices

The given passage explains how modern individuals face 'decision fatigue' due to endless digital options. It highlights how too many choices cause stress, dissatisfaction, and mental exhaustion. Hence, the main issue discussed is 'stress caused by excessive digital choices.'

Sol.259.(c) They limit exposure to diverse content

The given passage states "Algorithms, designed to predict preferences, often narrow exposure rather than broaden it, creating digital bubbles." This means that instead of expanding one's interests, algorithms restrict people to limited content based on their past behavior. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.260.(a) Choice leads to control but also exhaustion

The given passage highlights the paradox: "People may feel in control, yet their choices are subtly shaped by unseen patterns" and "too many choices can lead to stress, dissatisfaction, and even paralysis." Thus, while choice gives a sense of freedom, it simultaneously causes exhaustion. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.261.(c) Mindful engagement and limits. The given passage suggests "True digital freedom may lie not in limitless options, but in mindful engagement and setting personal boundaries." This clearly indicates that the solution is not simply reducing apps or increasing speed but managing usage wisely through awareness and limits. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.262.(b) Cautionary

In a cautionary tone, the author warns the readers about potential risks or dangers and encourages them to be careful or avoid certain actions. The given passage warns readers about the negative effects of excessive digital choices, such as stress, dissatisfaction, and decision fatigue. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 54

Sol.263.(d) System 2 allocates attention to effortful mental activities, such as solving complex problems or evaluating logical arguments. This sentence follows correct subject-verb agreement. 'System 2' is singular, and the verb 'allocates' correctly matches it.

Sol.264.(b) The biases, which influence our judgments, often lead to predictable errors.

This is the correct sentence because the relative pronoun 'which' is properly used to add non-essential information about 'biases'.

Sol.265.(b) Careful and intentional

In the context of the passage, 'deliberate' means thoughtful, careful, and intentional, describing the slow and rational nature of System 2 thinking. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.266.(a) Approve

The word "endorse" means to approve, support, or give backing to something. In the given sentence, System 2 prefers to endorse the intuitions of System 1 rather than question them, the meaning is approve or support. Hence, 'approve' is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.267.(c) It can be prone to biases and snap judgments.

(Line/s from the passage - "Because System 1 is prone to biases and snap judgments, we often make decisions that are not as rational as we believe.")

SET - 55**Sol.268.(c) Solar**

The given passage talks about the use of clean energy in a school, where solar panels are used to run fans, lights, and computers. Therefore, "solar" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.269.(c) Buy books and improve classrooms

(Line/s from the passage - the saved money is used to buy books and improve classrooms.)

Sol.270.(b) It does not cause pollution

(Line/s from the passage - students learn that solar power does not cause pollution like coal or petrol.)

Sol.271.(c) Install solar panels

(Line/s from the passage - the school has also inspired nearby houses to install solar panels.)

Sol.272.(c) Solar batteries

(Line/s from the passage - even on cloudy days, the solar battery stores enough power to keep the school running.)

SET - 56**Sol.273.(c) Ethical use of genetic engineering**

The given passage talks about how genetic engineering, though powerful and useful in treating diseases and crops, raises

serious ethical concerns about human enhancement, inequality, and long-term consequences. Hence, "ethical use of genetic engineering" is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.274.(c) It risks creating inequality

(Line/s from the passage - some argue that altering the human genome for non-medical reasons may lead to a new form of inequality—where the genetically modified have social advantages over others.)

Sol.275.(d) Science progresses rapidly

(Line/s from the passage - science often moves faster than legislation, leaving ethical frameworks lagging behind.)

Sol.276.(b) It can affect future generations

The given passage talks about how altering a gene may have effects that ripple through generations, showing that gene editing can impact the future. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.277.(c) "Caution must guide progress"

The given passage talks about the need for responsibility, reflection, and caution while using genetic engineering, even though science is advancing rapidly. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 57**Sol.278.(d)** Mahatma Gandhi

(Line/s from the passage- In 1930, Mahatma Gandhi started a peaceful protest called the Dandi March.)

Sol.279.(b) To protest salt tax

(Line/s from the passage- The purpose of the march was to protest the British law that taxed salt.)

Sol.280.(c) By making salt from the sea

(Line/s from the passage- He made salt from the sea at Dandi, breaking the law in a non-violent way.)

Sol.281.(c) 240 km

(Line/s from the passage- He and his followers walked 240 kilometers from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi, a village near the sea.)

Sol.282.(a) Peaceful protest and courage

As per the passage, the Dandi March is remembered today as a symbol of peaceful protest because Gandhi broke the salt law without using violence. It also shows courage, since he and his followers bravely stood against the British in a calm and non-violent way.

SET - 58**Sol.283.(c)** Loss of autonomy due to filtered choices

The passage says that when algorithms decide what we see or do online, we may slowly lose our freedom to choose for ourselves. This is the main concern of algorithmic living.

Sol.284.(b) Repeated exposure to similar content

In the passage, "feedback loop" means that algorithms keep showing us the same kind of content we already like. This repeats again and again, so we only see similar things and miss out on new or different ideas.

Sol.285.(c) It narrows perspective and reduces openness

The passage says that over time, algorithmic living can cause cognitive narrowing, which means people become less open to

new ideas or different views because they keep seeing only similar content.

Sol.286.(c) Practice critical engagement

The passage suggests that true digital well-being comes from being aware and thinking carefully about how we use algorithms, instead of just blindly following what they show us.

Sol.287.(b) Cautious and reflective

The passage carefully warns about the risks of relying too much on algorithms. It reflects on how they affect our choices and thinking, while also suggesting that we stay aware and thoughtful.

SET - 59**Sol.288.(c)** Threats to digital privacy

The main concern raised in the passage is threats to digital privacy. It explains that whenever people browse websites, click links, or use apps, their data is collected—often without their knowledge—and companies use it for ads, predictions, or even selling insights.

Sol.289.(c) Without users being fully aware

The passage clearly says that every time a user browses a website, clicks a link, or uses an app, their data is collected—sometimes without their knowledge.

Sol.290.(c) They exist but are poorly enforced

(Line/s from the passage- Some countries have passed laws to protect user data, but implementation remains weak.)

Sol.291.(b) Improving service experiences

The passage mentions that companies use collected data to target ads, predict behavior, and provide better services. This means that one positive use of user data is improving service experiences. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.292.(c) Awareness and responsible behavior

The passage concludes that individuals must balance the benefits of technology with the right to privacy, which requires awareness, regulation, and responsible digital behavior. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

SET - 60**Sol.293.(b)** Personalizing learning

(Line/s from the passage- From virtual tutors to personalized learning paths, AI helps identify each learner's strengths and weaknesses.)

Sol.294.(c) Poor thinking skills

The passage warns that over-dependence on AI may limit critical thinking, as students could lose problem-solving skills if they rely too much on machines. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.295.(c) To answer student questions

The passage states that schools use AI chatbots to answer basic questions asked by the students, which helps reduce the pressure on teachers. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Sol.296.(c) Data privacy

(Line/s from the passage- There are also concerns about data privacy, especially when student performance data is stored online.)

Sol.297.(c) Balance tech and human input

The author concludes that while AI can be useful, its effectiveness depends on balancing machine efficiency with human guidance. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

